

Step One: Name and Description

On your Character Sheet, give your Chronicler a name and provide a short description of who they are, why they joined the Mappa Mundi Institute, and what is motivating them to travel and explore the world.



Step two: Choose your Starting Licence

Your Chronicler's Starting Licence is the field they specialised in at the Mappa Mundi Institute.

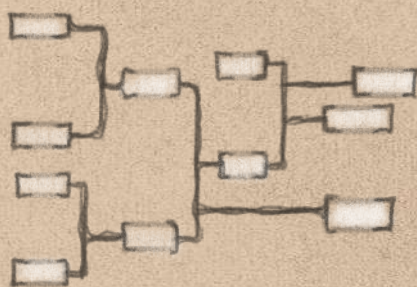
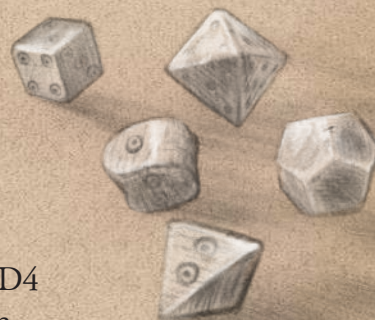
You have four options when choosing your Licence: **Archivist** (page 18), **Diviner** (page 28), **Fixer** (page 38), and **Guardian** (page 48).

While your choice of Starting Licence is important – it is easier to gain Skills related to your Starting Licence – it is not a restriction. You may unlock Skills from other Licences during your adventures.

Step three: Assign your Training

Each Chronicler begins with five Bones in their collection: a D2/coin (the Fate Bone), two D4s (four-sided dice), and two D6s (six-sided dice).

Your Starting Licence denotes which Ability is a Strength and which is a Weakness. Assign one D6 to your Strength and one D4 to your Weakness. Assign the remaining D4 and D6 as you wish.



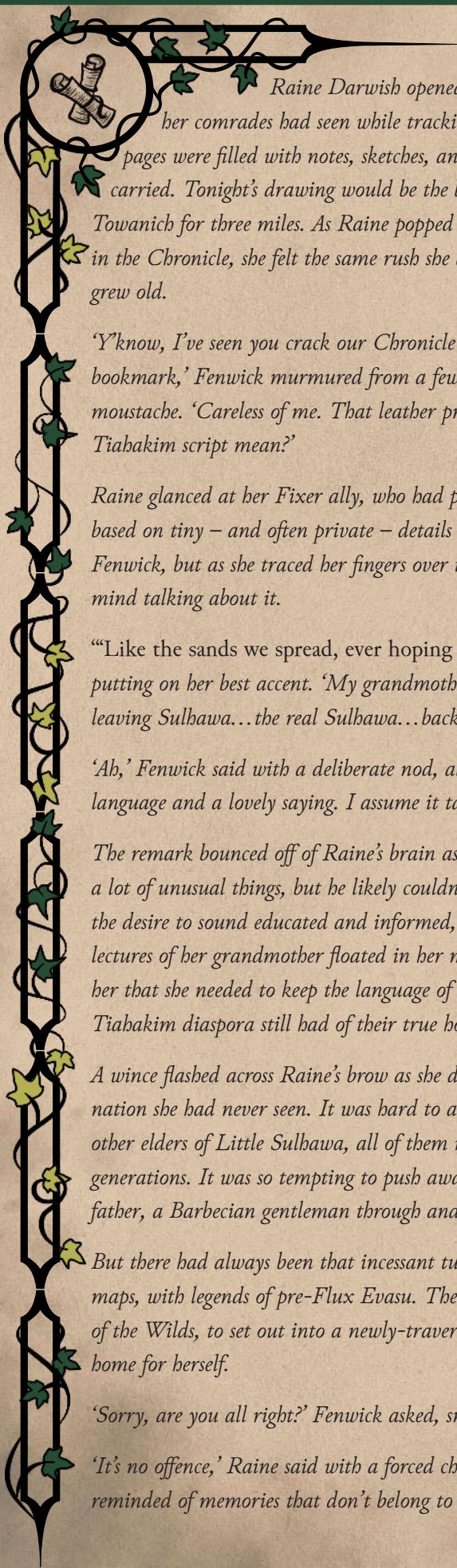
Step four: Choose your first Skills from your Licence's Skill Path

Each Licence has its own Skill Path. These Skill Paths represent your Chronicler's progression, and each Skill is associated with an Ability. Make a selection of Starting Skills from your Licence's Skill Path Starting Skills list, as determined by your Licence's instruction. Add these to your Character Sheet.

Step five: Choose your first Interactions from your Licence's available options

Each Licence has a number of available Interactions associated with their style of gameplay. To complete your Character Creation process, choose three of the Interactions listed on your Licence's instructions and add them to your Character Sheet.





Raine Darwish opened her pack and pulled out the party's Chronicle, a selection of everything she and her comrades had seen while tracking the beast that howled like a wolf. Thus far, eighty of the journal's two hundred pages were filled with notes, sketches, and deliberations that Raine had inscribed with the seven quill pens that she always carried. Tonight's drawing would be the beast's tracks, which had finally been spotted after trekking the fields north of Towanich for three miles. As Raine popped open an ink bottle and gently moved the red leather band that marked her place in the Chronicle, she felt the same rush she always did when settling down to write. The joy of putting pen to paper never grew old.

'Y'know, I've seen you crack our Chronicle open a thousand times, but this is the first instance I've noticed that very pretty bookmark,' Fenwick murmured from a few feet away, idly poking the fire with a stick while stroking the hairs of his moustache. 'Careless of me. That leather probably cost a fair few bezants, eh? Made in Little Sulhawa, I assume. What's the Tiabakim script mean?'

Raine glanced at her Fixer ally, who had proven himself to be the sort of fellow who really liked making idle conversation based on tiny – and often private – details that happened to catch his eye. Raine still wasn't certain what to make of Fenwick, but as she traced her fingers over the sinuous script that decorated the bookmark's edges, she realised that she didn't mind talking about it.

"Like the sands we spread, ever hoping for the wind to usher us back to the oasis of home." Raine read, carefully putting on her best accent. 'My grandmother gave this to me. It's a Tiabakimi saying that explorers used to murmur before leaving Sulhawa...the real Sulhawa...back in the old days.'

'Ah,' Fenwick said with a deliberate nod, almost as if he was filing this detail away in his head for later usage. 'Lovely language and a lovely saying. I assume it takes on something of a new meaning for you as a member of Mappa Mundi, eh?'

The remark bounced off of Raine's brain as she wondered why she'd cared so much about her accent just now. Fenwick knew a lot of unusual things, but he likely couldn't discern proper Tiabakimi from gibberish. Still, Raine knew she'd been hit with the desire to sound educated and informed, even more so than usual. Almost as if she were still a girl of twelve, the chiding lectures of her grandmother floated in her mind, telling her off for mixing too much Barbecian into her Tiabakimi, telling her that she needed to keep the language of the old country alive, because language was one of the few things that Moltiers' Tiabakim diaspora still had of their true home, that gorgeous land that they had been cut off from for more than a century.

A wince flashed across Raine's brow as she deliberated, for the millionth time, on what it meant to be a descendant of a nation she had never seen. It was hard to accept at face value the fragmented tales of her mother, her grandmother, and the other elders of Little Sulhawa, all of them reenacting as best they could scraps of culture that had disseminated via long generations. It was so tempting to push away that murky side of herself for the relatively clean and relatable stories of her father, a Barbecian gentleman through and through.

But there had always been that incessant tug in Raine's mind. The secret drive that fueled her obsession with history, with maps, with legends of pre-Flux Evasu. The unyielding urge that had caused her to join Mappa Mundi, to unearth the secrets of the Wilds, to set out into a newly-traversable world, and to one day visit Tiabakim. Where she would see the oasis of home for herself.

'Sorry, are you all right?' Fenwick asked, snapping Raine out of her reverie. 'I didn't mean to offend.'

'It's no offence,' Raine said with a forced chuckle, adjusting her spectacles and putting the bookmark away. 'I was just reminded of memories that don't belong to me. But maybe they will. Someday.'

Archivist

Archivists, the academics of the Mappa Mundi Institute, are a diverse bunch. Some are to be found burning the midnight oil, poring over accounts of stories, travels, and histories in the library. Others can be seen on the outskirts of towns and cities with ink and parchment in hand, mapping routes hidden and revealed. Others still are to be found deep in the Wilds, taking samples from Monsters, Creatures, plants, and trees alike, recording their findings with meticulous attention to detail.

Archivists are their party's map makers, note takers, historians, and knowledge keepers. Characterised by a curious soul, a thirst for knowledge, and an intellect to satisfy that thirst, those who choose the Archivist's path represent the inquisitiveness and desire to preserve that rests at the heart of the Mappa Mundi mission.

If you're an Archivist, you might...

- Keep track of local folklore, separating fact from fiction to determine the behaviours of Monsters and Creatures.
- Excel at surveying the land and keeping records of the uncharted Wilds your party travels through.
- Support your fellow Chroniclers with keen observations and a powerful intuition for discerning the unknown.

Training

Archivists have **Strength** in Observation and **Weakness** in Traversal

Starting Skills

Choose two **Observation Skills**, one **Deduction Skill**, and one **Exploration Skill** from the Archivist Skill Path Starting Skills

Starting Interactions

Choose three from the following: **Diagnose**; **Sketch**; **Study**; **Take Samples**; **Talk**

Specialisations

Cartographer - Biologist - Historian

Full descriptions of each Specialisation can be found on page 20.

Endorsements

Folklorist - Ecologist - Astrologer

Full descriptions of each Endorsement can be found on page 21.



Archivist Specialisations

Cartographer

Cartographers are those who specialise in map making, map reading, and analysing the features and dangers of a landscape. Years spent in the Wilds have seen them develop their practical skills alongside their theoretical knowledge, and travel has become familiar, if not second nature, to them.

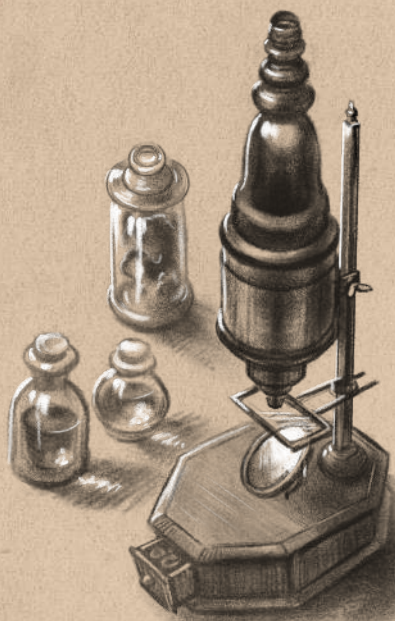
Rewards: When this Specialisation is unlocked, make a choice: unlock one Observation or Traversal Skill from each Skill Path, or gain +1 to all Observation and Traversal Checks during Journey Phases.



Biologist

The natural world is endlessly fascinating and, for most, largely unknowable. Not so for the Biologist. Monsters, Creatures, plants, and trees – each are books to be read and knowledge to be realised; living things to be cherished, studied, and understood.

Rewards: When this Specialisation is unlocked, gain access to the **Bait**, **Feed**, and **Diagnose Interactions** if not already unlocked. When these Interactions are used successfully, a Frayed Thread is automatically repaired in addition to revealing a Behaviour.



Historian

The tale of the future cannot be written without the legends of the past first found, understood, and written. Historians are those who combine an academic mind with an unquenchable desire for truth and experience. Going out into the world and hearing its stories is the only way the book of life can be written.

Rewards: Once per Chapter, after this Specialisation has been unlocked, the Archivist can ask the Narrator to reveal one piece of information about an NPC, Monster, Creature, location, or culture that might otherwise be hidden.



Archivist Endorsements



Folklorist

Requires Archivist Specialisation and Fixer - Envoy Specialisation

Folklorists act as Envoys on their travels, absorbing myths from many corners of the known world. This knowledge serves them well as they separate fact from fiction and extract kernels of truth from tall tales, folk tales, fairy tales, and everything in between.

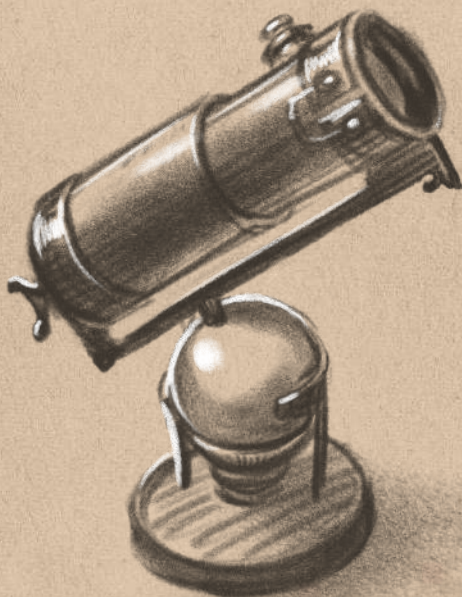
Rewards: When this Endorsement is unlocked, gain the **Sing** and **Talk Interactions** if not already unlocked. Whenever these Interactions are used, you may spend a Fate Point to repair a Severed Thread.

Ecologist

Requires Biologist Specialisation and any Guardian Specialisation

Ecologists possess an interest in the Monsters and Creatures of the world that goes far beyond the observational. Driven by a desire to enter the habitats of Ecumene's organisms, they gain the skills of Guardians to immerse themselves in the natural world.

Rewards: When this Endorsement is unlocked, make a choice: upgrade your Traversal dice to the next level, or all Chroniclers gain +1 to Observation Checks during the Journey and Encounter Phases.

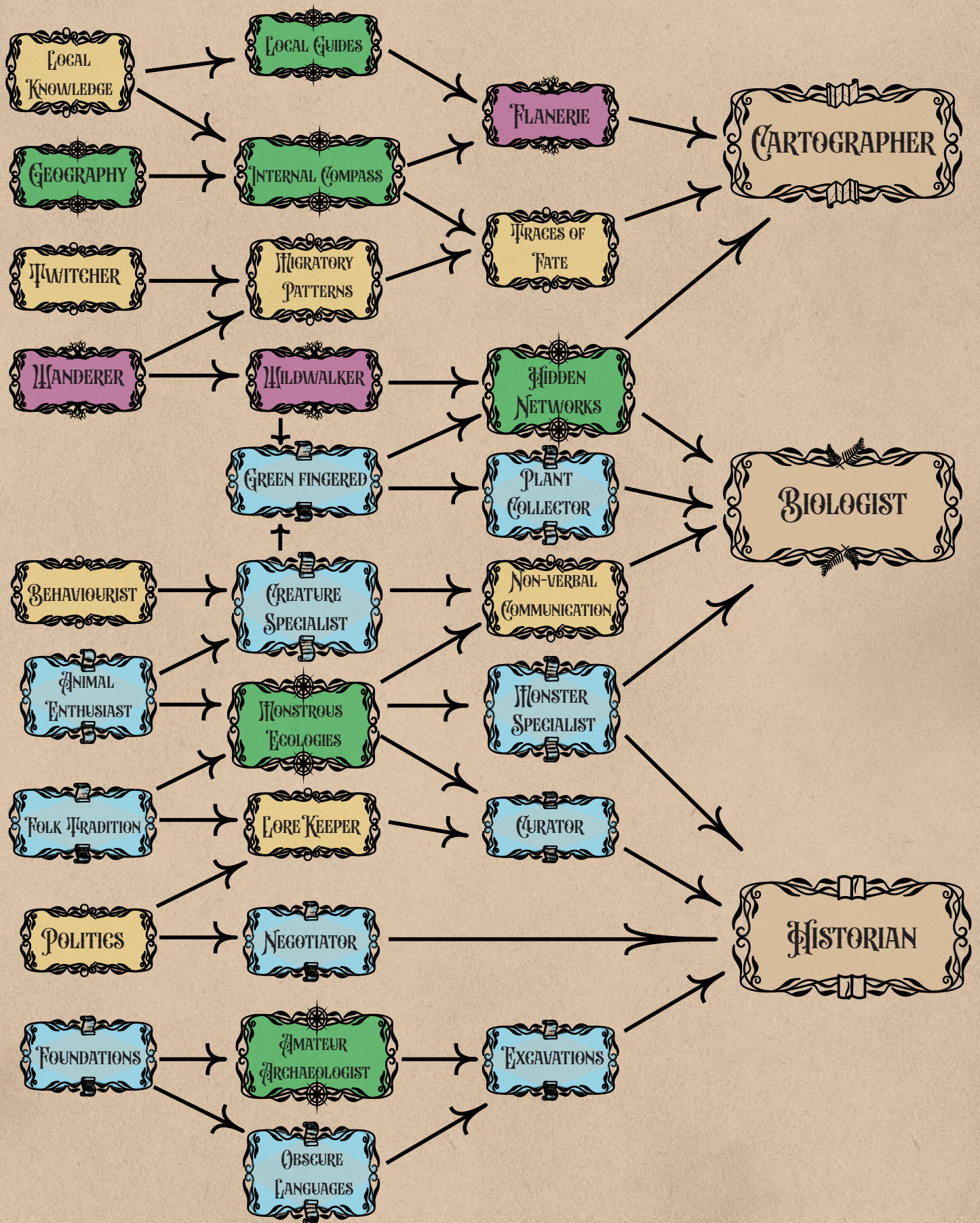


Astrologer

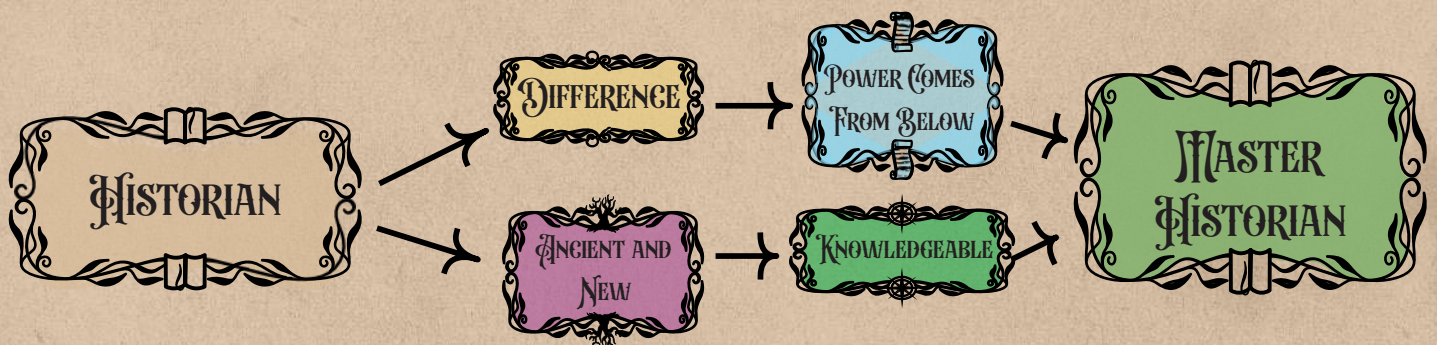
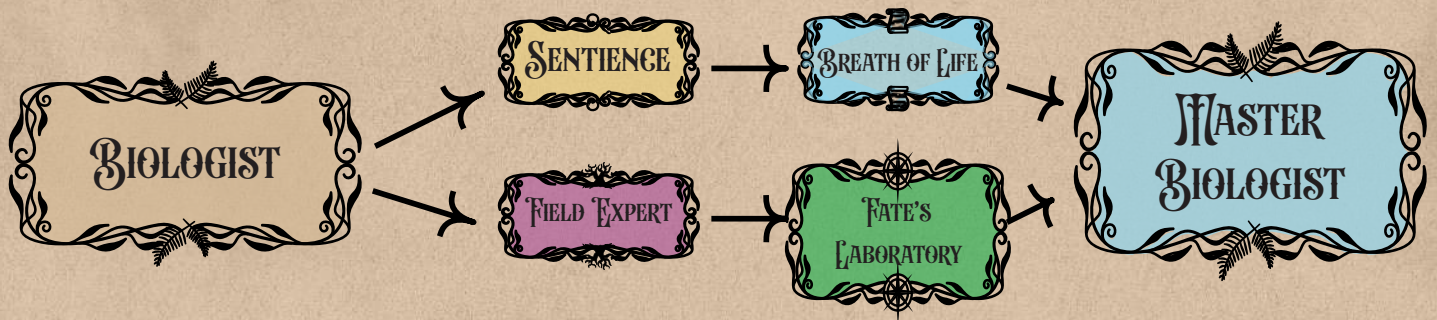
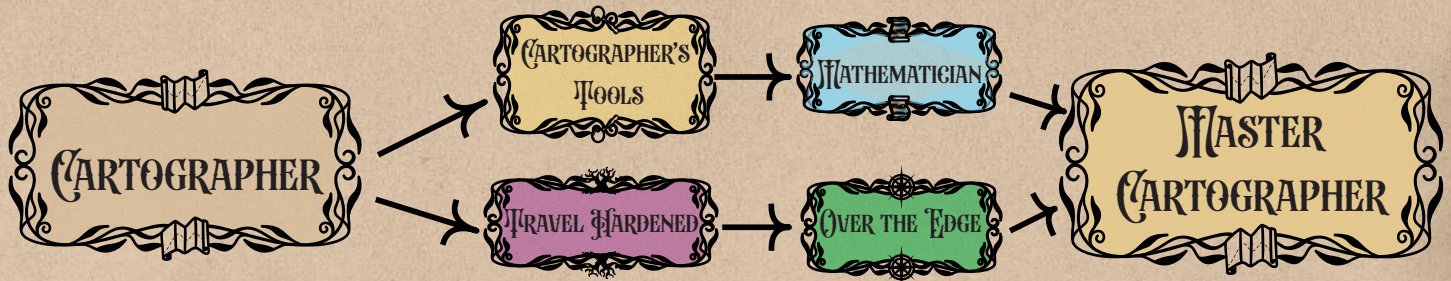
Requires Historian Specialisation and any Diviner Specialisation

Astrologers combine a deep knowledge of the heavens with a Diviner's insight into the patterns and plans of Fate. The stars hold hidden meanings to most, but not to them.

Rewards: When this Endorsement is unlocked, the Chronicler gains the **Predict Interaction**. Unique to this Endorsement, Predict can be used to reveal the presence of **Tiered Behaviours**. Once per Encounter, on request, the Astrologer can ask the Narrator to reveal whether any currently revealed Behaviour has a Tiered Behaviour linked to it. This Interaction is not linked to any Behaviours, but can be used in relation to Monsters, Creatures, and NPCs.



ARCHIVIST SKILL PATH



KEY:

OBSERVATION
EXPLORATION



DEDUCTION
TRAVERSAL





Archivist Starting Skills

Local Knowledge [Observation]

You were born in this region and have studied here for some years. As such, you are well acquainted with local customs. In lesser known areas of the region, you have a better chance at understanding cultural variants.

Geography [Exploration]

During your free hours, you wile away the time studying maps and speaking with foragers and gatherers. As a result, you have built up a robust mental map of the local area and are familiar with its major geographical features.

Twitcher [Observation]

You have devoted time to the study of birds and their migratory patterns. You know their favoured nesting grounds and recognise their calls. When the birdsong changes, you know the next season isn't far behind. With this knowledge, you can anticipate changes in the weather and ascertain your general location in your birth region.

Wanderer [Traversal]

The Wilds call to each and every person. Most ignore the whispers on the wind, hearkening back to fireside stories about the dangers that await the unprepared. But you were never one for listening too much to anyone, and you have spent your free time wandering the hidden paths and secret trails, going ever deeper into the Wilds beyond the borders.

Behaviourist [Observation]

Everything in this world is governed by behaviours. The attentive can observe these behaviours across individual beings. You excel at this, and you've even learned to anticipate and predict the commonalities between beings of various groups.

Animal Enthusiast [Deduction]

You have always felt an affinity for a certain type of Creature. When you were a child, you would imitate them, and now, as a Chronicler, you have carried that fascination with you, devoting your time to the study of both that Creature and its cultural significance.

Folk Tradition [Deduction]

Official histories tell official stories. Folk traditions, meanwhile, are where the subversive, the dangerous, the bawdy, and the cautionary stories can be found. The tales of princes and kings are one thing, but the stories of the woods, fields, rivers, and lowly people are quite another.

Politics [Observation]

The study of power is the study of politics. Perhaps you have political aspirations, or perhaps you believe that the powerful prey on the weak, and that the only way to protect the people is to play the powerful at their own game. Whatever your motivation is, you have studied the political and know that old enmities are often the reason new relationships fail.

Foundations [Deduction]

History is sanctioned myth, the fantastical made tangible, the foundations of culture covered with the edifices of the everyday. You have devoted yourself to the origins of people and cultures, back to the foundational stories of our world, and you can call these stories to mind when required.

Archivist Level One Skills

Local Guides [Exploration]

Forging connections with locals is a great means of gaining specific knowledge and clues regarding regional geography. You make sure to build these connections at the earliest opportunity, allowing you to call on guides as and when they are needed.

Internal Compass [Exploration]

No matter how thick the forest may be, no matter how sparse the desert, no matter how featureless the tundra, you always seem to know which direction to travel.

Migratory Patterns [Observation]

Out in the Wilds, humans are often inefficient creatures. The routes we take are rarely the most optimal and more often lead to danger rather than safety. Creatures, however, use their own highways and byways, and the study of migratory patterns has helped you to identify them.

Wildwalker [Traversal]

They say that time spent in the Wilds is a transformative experience; that while you change the landscape with your presence, it changes you, too. In your case, this is certainly true. Your affinity for this landscape is deeper than familiarity; it is kinship.

Green Fingert [Deduction]

The living world is fascinating and, for you, nothing is more fascinating than plant life. You take any opportunity to study plants, trees, shrubs, and flowers, jotting them down in your notes and even taking pressings.

— Creature Specialist [Deduction] —

Your time spent observing and working with Creatures has gained you the reputation of a specialist. You can be relied on to know a Creature's intricacies and its behaviours.

— Monstrous Ecologies [Exploration] —

The study of Monsters can be fraught with danger. These are some of the largest, smartest, most wily, and potentially intelligent beings alive. You have dedicated yourself to the study of Monster habitats, allowing you to make predictions about the way a Monster lives long before you reach its ecosystem.

— Lore Keeper [Observation] —

The peoples of Ecumene are diverse and varied. While some common understandings and customs bind them all together, each culture is unique. You have dedicated your study to understanding the stories and histories of a range of people, and your journeys into far regions are to both verify the stories you have heard and to learn more.

— Negotiator [Deduction] —

To bring together people riven by conflict is a noble skill. You have studied how to manage conflict, knowing that not all can be resolved, but that negotiation is the ground on which new agreements and understandings can be built.

— Amateur Archaeologist [Exploration] —

Some secrets are hidden in books, others in stories. The most elusive remain buried in the ground. In your spare time, you have been known to excavate abandoned sites, looking for the treasures of knowledge that are waiting to be found within.

— Obscure Languages [Deduction] —

Dead tongues hold living knowledge, or so your instructors taught you. Fascinated by the histories of those without voices left to speak, you have devoted yourself to learning those languages that many have forgotten, knowing that what was once worth sharing retains its value and importance, even if none are left to speak it.

Archivist Level Two Skills

— Flânerie [Traversal] —

Time in the Wilds is important, yes, but so is time in the city, for where else can one learn more about human cultures than in these hives of activity? You are skilled at reading the hidden and explicit routes of cities, and they now feel like a second home.

— Traces of Fate [Observation] —

Ecumene's natural historians agree on one thing: the substance of our world was drawn together by Fate. This act of creation, intentional or accidental, has left traces in the earth. These traces, be they shadows of intention or accidents, can be mapped.

— Hidden Networks [Exploration] —

All things are connected. The world is a single ecosystem made up of many webs and connections, joining all in a single network. Your study of life and its connections has given you insight into these hidden networks. You can exploit this knowledge for your own gain.

— Plant Collector [Deduction] —

Your pack is filled with samples and cuttings of plants, tree barks, leaves, and flowers, each gently harvested from locations visited during your travels. These are the cornerstone to your collection, which one day you hope will allow those from one side of the world to see and smell the plants from the other side.

— Non-Verbal Communication [Observation] —

Most assume that human-Monster or human-Creature communication is an impossibility; a beautiful dream, but nothing more. You, however, believe that those non-human beings we share this world with are capable of communication on levels beyond human abilities. To that end, you have studied multiple forms of non-verbal communication, all for that one opportunity to make contact with a being different to yourself.

— Monster Specialist [Deduction] —

Monsters are the most compelling entities to dwell on this planet. Your years of study and devotion to these beings have made you a recognised expert, and when someone has a question about Monsters, it is usually you they come to.

— Curator [Deduction] —

Over an extended period in the Wilds, one tends to collect materials from different landscapes and to receive gifts from different peoples. These items are worthy of respect, and to tell their story properly relies on the skill of a curator.

— Excavations [Deduction] —

Your pursuit of the historical has led you into a number of subterranean situations. These environments rarely feel natural, though you have become more accustomed than most at keeping your head when you need to venture underground.



Cartographer Skills

— Cartographer's Tools [Observation] —

Your mastery of the mapmaker's craft has relied, in part, on your expertise with the tools of the trade. Armed with compasses, sextants, and astrolabes, you have moved beyond the dead reckoning practised by amateurs and can determine your position – and that of landmarks, terrain features, and natural phenomena – with striking precision and accuracy.

— Mathematician [Deduction] —

Determining latitude and longitude, tracing a path by the position of the stars, and providing accurate information about altitude, depth, and distance are difficult skills. Your aptitude for mathematics makes solving the challenges of space and place a joy, rather than a chore. Numbers are the foundations of the world, so a mathematical mind is one with a glimpse into Fate's design.

— Travel Hardened [Traversal] —

You volunteered to travel the Wilds, getting lost beyond the borders of the old to draw maps so others wouldn't have to lose their way. Name it, and there is a good chance you've fallen into it, off it, through it, or out of it. But you wear your weatherbeaten cloak with pride, and every tear, scratch, and bruise is just another story to tell of the glories of the Wilds.

— Over the Edge [Exploration] —

Since the Flux, even before it, most people feared what lay over the edge of the map, beyond the borders of home and the comforts of a sheltered life. You might even have been one of them. But now? Now you've seen what lies over the edge. A life where nothing is surprising is not one worth living, but you retain your capacity for surprise, even if fear of the unknown has left you.

— Master Cartographer [Observation] —

The world is contour lines charting local relief. The world is ink on parchment, tracing paths through the Wilds. The world is grids and numbers, labels and tags, notes of explanation describing the intricacies of the unknown. The world, as you know, is this, and so much, much more.

Biologist Skills

— Sentience [Observation] —

There are those who regard Monsters and Creatures as nothing more than a collection of instincts and fears, driven by the desire to survive. You know better than this.

Sentience and consciousness are not the preserve of humanity (which, after all, can be described as nothing more than a collection of instincts and fears). The world is a vessel for consciousness, and everything contains a share.

— Breath of Life [Deduction] —

Discussions about the soul are the preserve of Diviners. But the theory of an animating presence, some vital essence, that dwells within all life has begun to take root in your mind during your time in the Wilds. You hear it in the trees, see it in the eyes of Monsters and people alike, feel it in the warmth of a Creature as you touch it. You can sense it from afar, essential and reassuring.

— Field Expert [Traversal] —

The samples you have taken from every imaginable environment, Monster, and Creature, the foods you have tasted, the stories you have heard, the challenges you have overcome in pursuit of your craft, the practical experiments gone right and wrong – all of them have made you an expert traveller. Your opinions on the domains of life and death are listened to wherever you go.

— Fate's Laboratory [Exploration] —

If you have learned one thing during your journey, it is this: Fate is a biologist. The Wilds are a place of experimentation, of radical change and violent revolution. The Flux may not have been a disaster or a loss of control, but the next stage in this great experiment. But, like all with a scientific mind, you can see order in chaos, planning in tumult, and can anticipate chance and its consequences.

— Master Biologist [Deduction] —

The world is blood and bone, keeping life moving and standing. The world is teeth and claws, skin, fur, scales. The world is samples, experiments, solutions to solve the great question: what are we? The world, as you know it, is life, breath, experience, and joy in the unanswerable.

Historian Skills

— Difference [Observation] —

Your research and years of study have taught you two fundamental truths: difference divides, and difference unites. You have travelled to more places, met more people, experienced more major events and examples of the everyday than almost any before you. You have changed; this journey has changed you. Where once you were outside, now you can fit. Respect for difference has paid dividends.

— Power Comes From Below [Deduction] —

Many think that power rests in the hearts of the powerful, might in the hands of the mighty, influence in the mouths of the influential. You know this is an illusion. Power, might, and influence come from below; they are the province of the many. You have pierced the veil, unmasked the actor. What should you do with this knowledge? Why, share it, of course. It belongs to those on their knees.

— Ancient and New [Traversal] —

History is not just the preserve of people. The Wilds have their own histories, etched into stone, bark, and soil. The age of the world is ancient, the story of the world is new. You are one author of this history, your mark left behind you in ink and parchment. But the Wilds record history in their own way, their stories told over aeons. You know where to look for and how to read this history.

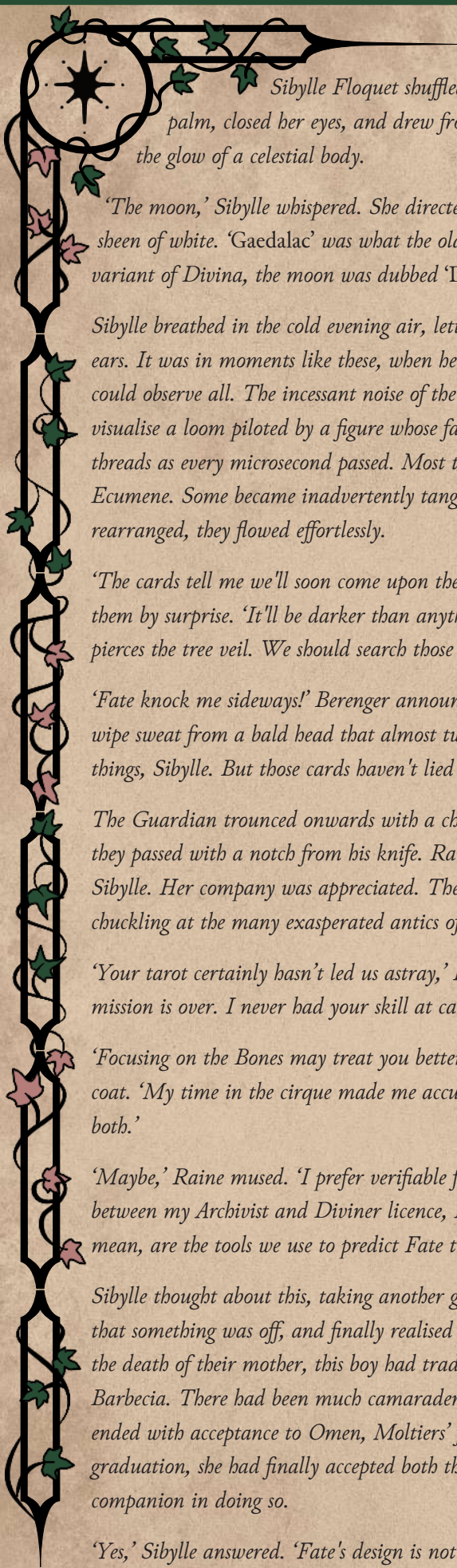
— Knowledgeable [Exploration] —

There are few living who can match you. What you know could fill a library, and one day it will. You are in possession of an accumulated knowledge the likes of which the world has never seen before. Taken with respect, you are the custodian of generations, of beginnings and ends. When someone wants to know something, you can search your knowledge banks. If it isn't there, you know how to find it.

— Master Historian [Exploration] —

The world is facts and figures: dates, names, and numbers. The world is events and great people, writ large with fury and blood. The world is contained in the pages of a book, inert, dead, nearly forgotten. The world, as you know, is in the hands of the people, the beating heart of the Wilds.





Sibylle Floquet shuffled her tarot deck and peered at the stars. She organised the cards neatly in her left palm, closed her eyes, and drew from the top of the deck. It was the image of a man and a woman standing against the glow of a celestial body.

'The moon,' Sibylle whispered. She directed her gaze over the constellations, towards the orb that painted the forest in a sheen of white. 'Gaedalaç' was what the old Barics had named the moon - 'she who sees in the sky.' And in Barbecia's variant of Divina, the moon was dubbed 'Destwaynas' - 'the one who observes all.'

Sibylle breathed in the cold evening air, letting it enter her nostrils as the cosmic geometry of Fate filled the space between her ears. It was in moments like these, when her cards spoke to her, connecting the dots in the fabric of existence, that she really could observe all. The incessant noise of the world finally came to a standstill, and in these precious seconds, she could visualise a loom piloted by a figure whose face was covered in shadow. This figure operated the loom, spinning thousands of threads as every microsecond passed. Most threads flowed eagerly into the fabric of a tapestry that bordered the entirety of Ecumene. Some became inadvertently tangled, and the loom needed to be briefly stopped so as to rearrange them. But once rearranged, they flowed effortlessly.

'The cards tell me we'll soon come upon the thickest part of the wood,' Sibylle announced to her party members, catching them by surprise. 'It'll be darker than anything we've traversed thus far, aside from small patches of grass where moonlight pierces the tree veil. We should search those patches for signs. Perhaps tufts of fur, perhaps remains of its prey.'

'Fate knock me sideways.' Berenger announced from the head of the party, removing his plumed helmet for a moment to wipe sweat from a bald head that almost twinkled as brightly as the moon. 'I still don't understand how you know these things, Sibylle. But those cards haven't lied yet, so onwards we go! To the thickest part of the wood! For Mappa Mundi!'

The Guardian trounced onwards with a cheer, eliciting a roll of the eyes from Fenwick, who was marking every seventh tree they passed with a notch from his knife. Raine, who took up the rear of the party's formation, smiled and walked beside Sibylle. Her company was appreciated. The pair had spent much time together since setting off on this journey, often chuckling at the many exasperated antics of Berenger and Fenwick.

'Your tarot certainly hasn't led us astray,' Raine said. 'Makes me wonder if I should try to take up divining again once this mission is over. I never had your skill at card reading.'

'Focusing on the Bones may treat you better,' Sibylle replied, sliding her cards into the sleek case attached to the front of her coat. 'My time in the cirque made me accustomed to the tarot. Most people find solace in one or the other, not necessarily both.'

'Maybe,' Raine mused. 'I prefer verifiable facts. The vagueness of doing what you do is difficult. Back when I was deciding between my Archivist and Diviner licence, I'd sometimes roll the Bones and feel unconfident in results that seemed wrong. I mean, are the tools we use to predict Fate truly accurate? Or is Fate sometimes capable of errors?'

Sibylle thought about this, taking another glance at the moon. She remembered, for an instant, a boy who had always known that something was off, and finally realised that the loom of Fate should have spun their threads into the body of a girl. After the death of their mother, this boy had traded the misery of Zalfluer for seven years of travelling performances across Barbecia. There had been much camaraderie, soul-searching, and tarot reading in those years. And finally, the circus days ended with acceptance to Omen, Moltiers' famed divination school. When Sibylle walked from Omen's doors upon graduation, she had finally accepted both the beauty of Fate and its many unpredictable vagaries. And the cards were her companion in doing so.

'Yes,' Sibylle answered. 'Fate's design is not always correct. But we can rearrange it, if we so wish.'

Diviner

Whisperers. Seers. Conduits. Witches. All names commonly associated with Diviners. What each holds in common, however, is a link with Fate herself. Some speak with Fate through the Bones, their familiar clicks a hidden language. Others interpret Fate's plan through cards, reading life, death, and patterns from the infinite combinations. The rarest of all immerse themselves in nature, soaking up each and every stimulus, foretelling the future in the flights of birds, the whisper of the wind, or the crunch of the soil underfoot.

Diviners are a party's link to the otherworldly and unusual. Characterised by an intensity and the ability to look beneath the surface of any situation, those who choose the Diviner's path represent the recognition of life and Fate as inextricably bound forces.

If you're a Diviner, you might...

- Consult your cards on a regular basis and possess a preternatural sense for the tendencies of Fate.
- Rattle a lucky set of Bones in a cup at odd intervals, confident that you can foretell Fate's ever-accumulating design.
- Act as an esoteric presence amongst your fellow Chroniclers, making predictions on a grand scale that aren't always understood until they come true.

Training

To determine your Diviner's Strength and Weakness, assign one of your Abilities to each side of a D4. Roll twice. The first result is your Diviner's Strength; the second is your Diviner's Weakness.

Starting Skills

Choose two **Deduction Skills**, one **Observation Skill**, and one **Exploration Skill** from the Diviner Skill Path Starting Skills.

Starting Interactions

Choose three from the following: **Gift**; **Read**; **Sing**; **Soothe**; **Touch**

Specialisations

Cartomancer - **Ossiomancer** - **Augur**

Full descriptions of each Specialisation can be found on page 30.

Endorsements

Geomancer - **Conduit** - **Tasseomancer**

Full descriptions of each Endorsement can be found on page 31.



Diviner Specialisations

Cartomancer

Cartomancers hold a special affinity for the cards. The Cartomancer's journey to mastery often starts small, providing short readings to friends, family, and neighbours. With the right Training, Cartomancers soon develop a sixth sense for Fate's design and can anticipate her influence in their lives.

Rewards: Once per Chapter, in the Research Phase, a Cartomancer may examine a card the Narrator has placed into the Journey Deck. The Cartomancer must not reveal this card, but may change its orientation if they wish.



Ossiomancer

Bone magicians, charnel artists, death carvers. Ossiomancers have long suffered under a general suspicion from the peoples of Ecumene, but their craft – the carving and interpretation of Bones – is a necessary one. Ossiomancers know that their art is the vital link that connects the everyday to the whims of Fate, and their insights are always called upon.

Rewards: When this Specialisation is unlocked, make a choice: upgrade the lowest value die belonging to two Chroniclers to the next level, or all Chroniclers may re-roll one die per Phase.

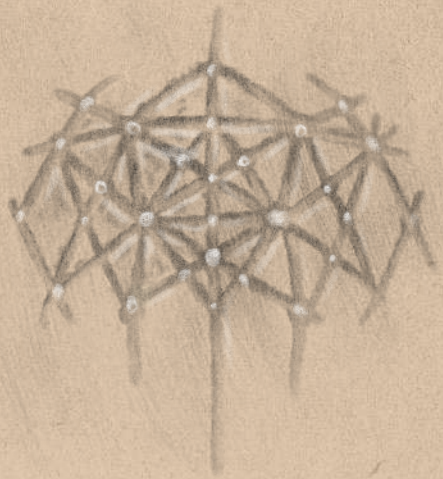
Augur

For those with the eyes to see, the Wilds contain verdant knowledge. For those with the ears to hear, the wind shares whispers of Fate's design. For those with the hands to touch, the bark of the trees and the flow of the stream contain infinite patterns. Augurs interpret these signs, basking in the true depth of nature's majesty.

Rewards: When this Specialisation is unlocked, make a choice: gain one Observation Skill from any Skill Path, or add the equivalent of one Rightwise Journey Card to the total when the Narrator determines a target's Posture for each Encounter Phase.



Diviner Endorsements



Geomancer

Requires any Diviner Specialisation and Archivist - Cartographer Specialisation

Much can be learned from the hidden ley lines that criss-cross the known world. Geomancers combine a Cartographer's knowledge of terrain with an astute understanding of these delicate arrangements of rock and soil, predicting changes in topography and the whims of the heavens with incredible accuracy.

Rewards: Chroniclers with this Endorsement gain +2 to all Traversal Checks related to terrain conditions. Once per Chapter, the Geomancer may spend five Fate Points to change the terrain in some fashion.

Conduit

Requires any Diviner Specialisation and Guardian - Warden Specialisation

If Monsters are incarnations of Fate's will, Conduits are the translators who interpret this will and share it with all. These erudite decipherers study Warden methods of communicating with Monsters, often using a combination of body language and their five senses to discern what Fate's children are thinking.

Rewards: Chroniclers with this Endorsement automatically succeed whenever using the **Commune Interaction**. When this Endorsement is unlocked, the Chronicler gains the **Soothe Interaction** and can use it to automatically repair one Frayed Thread.

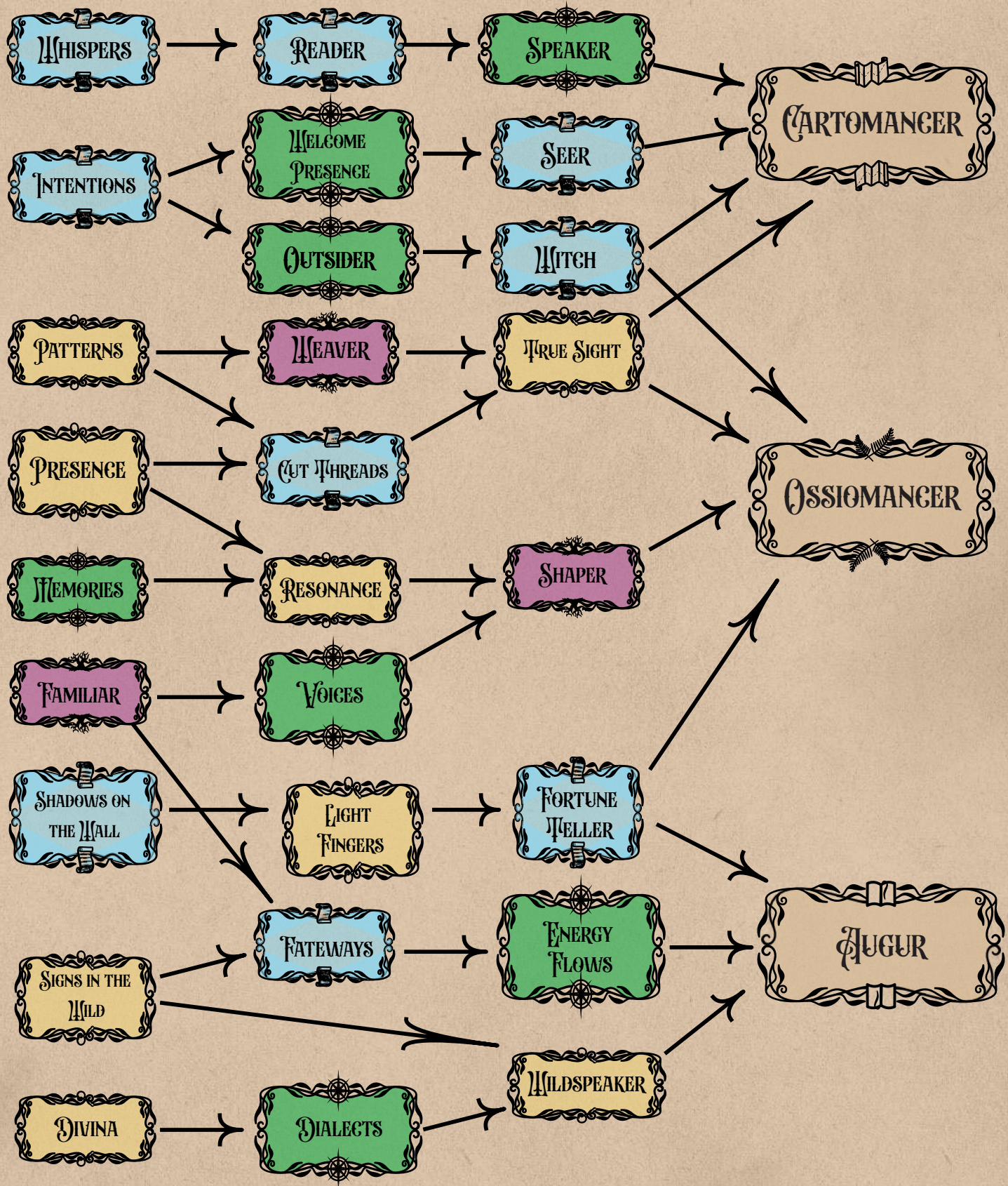


Tasseomancer

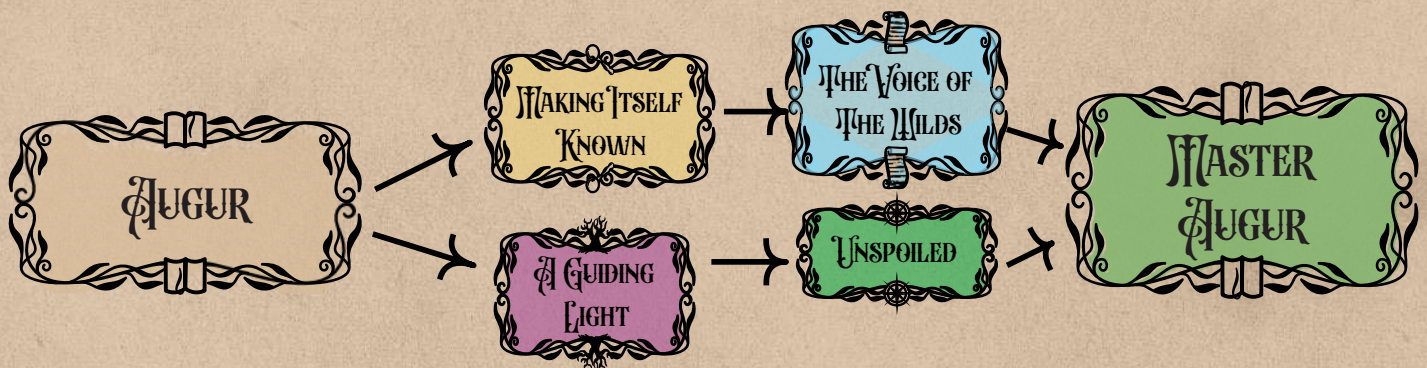
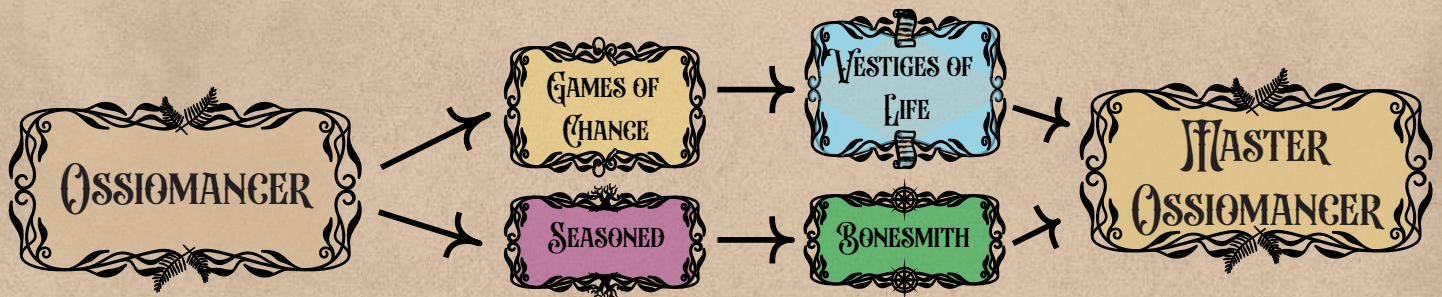
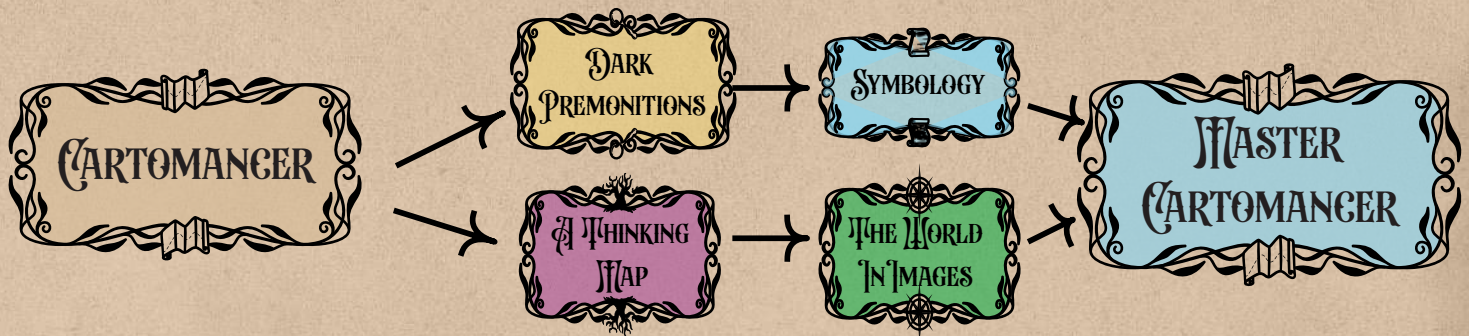
Requires any Diviner Specialisation and Fixer - Scavenger Specialisation

Tasseomancy is a rare art, and the knowledge to read Fate's plans from tea leaves and other plant-based samples is exceedingly difficult to come by. Those who have mastered the art find themselves able to understand the deepest facets of a Monster, Creature, or other denizen of the Wilds by interpreting taste, colour, and smell.

Rewards: When this Endorsement is unlocked, the Chronicler gains the **Take Samples Interaction**. The Tasseomancer may use samples gained in this way to receive insights into the Behaviours of the relevant target. When a tea is brewed from these samples, the Tasseomancer may ask the Narrator to reveal an Interaction linked to that target's Behaviours.



DIVINER SKILL PATH



KEY:

OBSERVATION



EXPLORATION



DEDUCTION



TRAVERSAL





Diviner Starting Skills

— Whispers [Deduction] —

Your gift was always there, but it took time for your ears to register it. You hear the whisper of Fate, carried on the wind, in the rustle of leaves, as a faint hum underneath the voices of those around you. If you listen closely enough, you can hear Fate speaking through the world.

— Intentions [Deduction] —

How does free will exist in a world governed by Fate? Scholars and philosophers have driven themselves mad pondering the question. For you, the answer is simpler: intention is the tool by which Fate is shaped, and you possess great skill at seeing the intentions around you.

— Patterns [Observation] —

Fate adores patterns. If any could see its full extent, they say, the tapestry of Fate would match the beauty of the world itself. None can see Fate's full plan, but you can recognise the patterns in tiny fragments of the everyday.

— Presence [Observation] —

You have always felt an affinity for the Bones, the tokens by which the people of Ecumene try to ascertain the will of Fate before acting. Nearly every person carries their own set of Bones, and you can feel when someone has asked questions of them recently.

— Memories [Exploration] —

When navigating a place with your Bones, you can sometimes sense memories from long ago. Perhaps these memories are from the Bones themselves – after all, they were once living things. Who is to say that they aren't still alive and seeking answers of their own? To feel those memories, to understand the questions asked and answered, is to understand the true role the Bones play.

— Familiar [Traversal] —

Many people roll their Bones for luck before attempting difficult physical ordeals. Some claim this habit is simple superstition, but you know that there is strength in it. When exerting yourself, your Bones can offer boons and blessings you might otherwise not have expected.

— Shadows on the Wall [Deduction] —

Diviners are more than just adept at reading people. Many are illusionists, using their reputation to pass off sleight of hand as the whims of Fate. Some frown on such tricks, but others know that Fate sometimes needs a helping hand.

— Signs in the Wild [Observation] —

Diviners understand that Fate works through everything. Nowhere is this connection more apparent than in the behaviours of Creatures and Monsters. By pinpointing these signs in the wild, you can sense features of Ecumene's organisms that most wouldn't be able to identify.

— Divina [Observation] —

Several groups have secret languages they communicate in. Diviners are no different. Though there are many dialects of Divina, all combine words, hand gestures, and vocal clicks, and Divina is mutually intelligible across regions.

Diviner Level One Skills

— Reader [Deduction] —

With time and practice, the cards – tools used to divine people's futures and answer their questions – can be read like a book. It is a rare talent that can read beyond the surface meanings contained within the deck, glimpsing into the weaves beyond, but that gift belongs to you.

— Welcome Presence [Exploration] —

Diviners are a polarising group. Though Fate's influence in the world is well accepted, superstitions surrounding the second sight are still widespread. Growing up, people looked to your gift as a blessing and a boon, and wherever you go people seem drawn to you and your wisdom.

— Outsider [Exploration] —

From an early age you knew that people looked at you differently. At times it was difficult to discern whether the whispers you heard were from Fate herself or from those around you. Eventually you took to isolating yourself, recognising that there was safety in solitude. You are now practised at passing unseen and avoiding suspicious gazes.

— Weaver [Traversal] —

In the more treacherous areas of the Wilds, travellers have been known to weave string along their route, ensuring that they can return home the way they came. This physical practice is an unconscious manifestation of Fate's threads.

You don't need to rely on these physical guides, as Fate makes her threads visible to you.

— Cut Threads [Deduction] —

Woven by Fate herself, a life lasts the length of its thread.

But threads can be cut, and lives extinguished too soon. When you come upon signs of death, you possess the sight to see how and when a thread was cut, and even by whom.

— Resonance [Observation] —

Each choice, each decision, each footstep changes the flow of the weave. Fate's tapestry is a work constantly in progress, and the vibrations one's choices make can be felt across the skein. Quieting your mind and sensing these vibrations allows you to feel a person's resonance in your current location and steal a glimpse into their life.

— Voices [Exploration] —

If Bones were once living things with memories, who is to say they don't retain a voice? Who is to say that they don't have words of wisdom to share? When exploring a location, you've learned to 'speak' to the voices that emanate from your Bones and any you might encounter in your travels.

— Light Fingers [Observation] —

Taking from those in need is wrong. But taking from those with more than they need? Well, that's for the whims of Fate to decide. As a Diviner with light fingers, you're always aware of the right moment to grab hold of something that doesn't belong to you, but has a higher purpose in your hands thanks to Fate's grand plan.

— Fateways [Deduction] —

Almost all can follow someone at a short distance. But very few can sense the tracks a person leaves through the Fateways. Everyone leaves a trace, and you can deduce that trace, discerning where someone has been or where they are going with careful study.

— Dialects [Exploration] —

You can often tell a lot about someone by their dialect. Where they're from, whether there was more or less money in the house, and whether they grew up giving orders or taking them. You have learned not only to recognise dialect but to mask it, allowing you to blend into social situations that some might say are not yours by birth.

Diviner Level Two Skills

— Speaker [Exploration] —

The very best Diviners know that the cards are not just a tool for reading and instruction, but are one side of a conversation. When consulting the cards for information, you can converse with them as you would a close comrade, learning much from the seemingly esoteric answers their illustrations provide.

— Seer [Deduction] —

Wherever you go, people recognise you as a possessor of the second sight. The troubled, the poor, the rich, and the powerful all flock to you, seeking your wisdom and insight. While you are always willing to help, the price people often pay is your knowledge of their future, however uncomfortable that may be.

— Witch [Deduction] —

Beguiler. Hexer. Witch. These are words that follow you whenever you appear, along with fear and intimidation. Of course, you are none of these things. But fear can be a useful tool, and you also don't mind taking advantage of people's perceptions of you when it proves convenient.

— True Sight [Observation] —

Truth and lies weave different patterns. With practice, you have learned to recognise those patterns as each person speaks them, giving you a preternatural sense of when someone is being honest or not.

— Shaper [Traversal] —

Years of long practice have given you an affinity for your chosen tools of either the Bones or the cards. Through you, these items, imbued with the second sight and touched by Fate herself, help shape the world, changing the destinies of those you call friends.

— Fortune Teller [Deduction] —

You remember them from childhood: travellers, bedecked in motley clothes or pied in many colours, who appeared in your village square offering fortune readings. You also remember everyone's purses were much lighter after they left, even if they hadn't spent any money. Everyone has to make a living, right?

— Energy Flows [Exploration] —

Fate weaves a vital essence through all things, living and dead. You can follow flows related to this energy with excellent accuracy, noticing minute details such as the path that a Creature trod before it died, or the hidden route it took to hunt its food source.

— Wildspeaker [Observation] —

The Wilds have always talked to you. Trees speak through ancient creaking, the wind in whispers, and Creatures through a bristling energy. You have heard these languages for so long they are as familiar as your own voice. One day, you spoke back. And the Wilds listened.



Cartomancer Skills

Dark Premonitions [Observation]

Diviners find solace in reading the cards. It is at once a meditation and an action; contemplation that seeks change or control. You have gained a level of insight almost unmatched. But this dedication has opened up a dark path. You can sense the depths of the problems people face when you perform readings for them, offering a window into inner darkness.

Symbology [Deduction]

You have grown used to the symbolism of the cards as they apply to your own background and training. What you have come to realise, though, is that cards, like languages, are different when borders are crossed, and are mere representations of the multitude of symbols that exist in the Wilds. You are adept at reading and understanding these symbols no matter where you are or what form they take.

A Thinking Map [Traversal]

Your journeys in the Wilds have taught you one thing: cards can be just as good a guide as even the best maps. Trusting the cards to guide your way may seem like a fool's errand, but your trust is repaid tenfold. Your ability to read direction, distance, altitude, and danger from your deck is second to none. They have gotten you out of trouble before, and there is no reason to think they won't again.

The World in Images [Exploration]

You have travelled to places and seen things beyond your wildest imagination. The cultures you have encountered have introduced new cards to your deck, your experiences have given you more to draw on in your readings, and the Monsters you have encountered shaped your understanding of the world. You know more, and can see more, than you ever thought possible.

Master Cartomancer [Deduction]

The world is desperate questions without answers, asked in fear. The world is a spread of cards, as mindless as the wood they rest on. The world is an unknowable chaos, formless, without rhyme or reason. The world, as you know, is more than this; an open book waiting to be read.

Ossiomancer Skills

Games of Chance [Observation]

When you were growing up, your grandparents taught you to respect the Bones. 'They're not toys!' And so you treated them like sacred objects, honouring their insights. Your journeys have taught you that this is not always the way. Games are life and play unites. People across the world use their Bones in games of chance, and you have learned their rules.

Vestiges of Life [Deduction]

Only the oldest sets of inherited Bones are still made of the substance they are named for. Most are now made of wood or stone. But just as bone was once a living thing, so is wood and stone. You are an expert at reading the Bones, but not just the numbers or signs they reveal. You can sense the past lives Bones and their owners have lived, and they are much, much older than you.

Seasoned [Traversal]

You have called on your Bones to help you make decisions both great and small. Ossiomancers believe that the more the Bones are used, the more adept they become at imparting advice. Some say that it is the reader who becomes honed by experience, but you know your Bones, and these are seasoned. Whenever you're in greatest need, you know they'll point you right or get you out of trouble.

Bonesmith [Exploration]

Most Ossiomancers can give advice to a person seeking a new set of Bones. The advice goes that the material should be something familiar to them, or something that matches what they're trying to replace. But your journeys have opened your eyes to unfamiliar possibilities! The materials used for Bones are as varied as the cultures that use them, and you have an eye for crafting new sets.

Master Ossiomancer [Observation]

The world is scraps and detritus, cast aside without regard. The world is the clink of coins and the thunk of shovels in mud. The world is fixed, unchanging, immutable and cold to the cries of downtrodden. The world is a test of chance, a flash of luck, a game of life's essence revealing the road.

Augur Skills

— Making Itself Known [Observation] —

You have the greensight. You have seen the sands tell stories, the snows whisper soft nothings, the rain and the storm show the rage of the Wilds. You have felt the mycological connections thrum under the forest floor, and walked the greenways, the stoneways, the waterways under the guidance of the earth. You have seen. You have heard.

You will follow the signs, again and again.

— The Voice of the Wilds [Deduction] —

It is common knowledge that Monsters and Creatures have agency. Like humans, they live rich inner lives and react to the world around them. It is less common to believe that the Wilds have agency. You, though, know this to be true. Not only do the Wilds think, feel, and react, they speak. Your journeys have taught you to hear this voice without noise, this agency without sound.

— A Guiding Light [Traversal] —

The Wilds contain multitudes. They are neither good nor evil, kind nor cruel, welcoming nor shunning. The Wilds simply are. Augurs feel the Wilds more than others. Your journeys have exposed you to every kind of terrain you can imagine. And while the Wilds may not care for you, they do notice you. You, and you alone, it feels. You are a guiding light in the Wilds, as they are a guide for you.

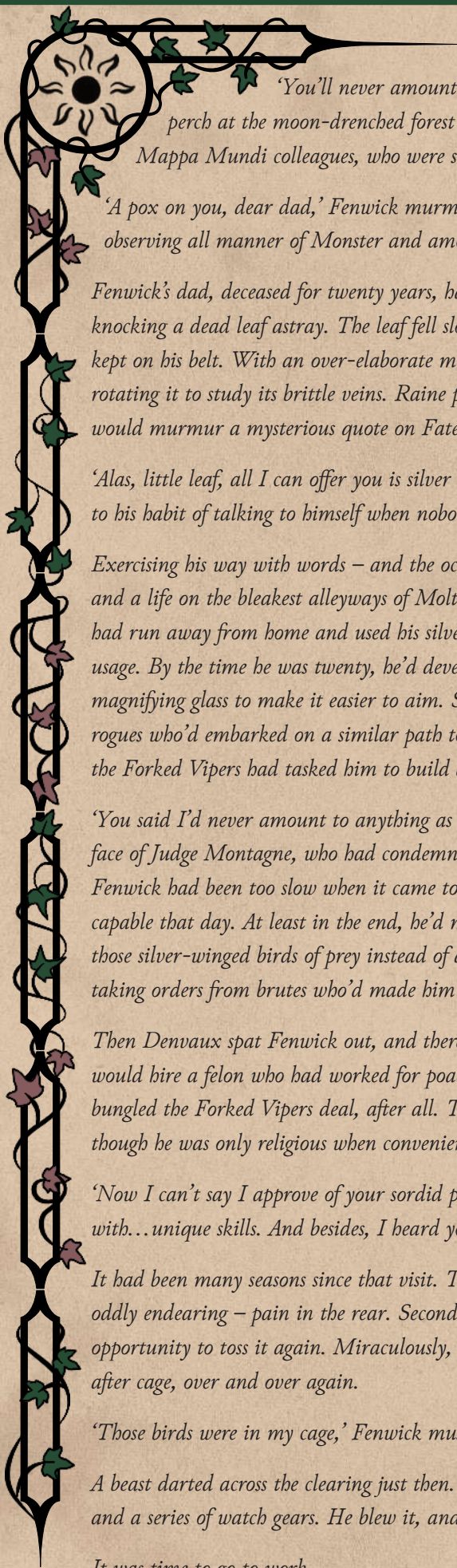
— Unspoiled [Exploration] —

Nothing gives you greater joy than the spectacle of the Wilds unspoiled. Areas untouched by human interference are shrinking, and even you change this state of being. But you have come to realise that everything is unspoiled, that humans are just as much a part of the Wilds you love as Monsters and Creatures, trees, rivers, and deserts. You see the best in humanity, and they see it in you, too.

— Master Augur [Exploration] —

The world is a green terror, mud, blood, and suffering. The world is struggle, survival, storm and darkness. The world is a roiling sea, a sandstorm, a blizzard, a flood. The world, as you know, is much more. The world is a beating heart, a grasping hand, a toothed smile beaming.





'You'll never amount to anything,' Fenwick Moreau thought as he used a spyglass to peer from his tree perch at the moon-drenched forest floor. He often recalled his father's words when he was keeping watch for his Mappa Mundi colleagues, who were several feet below.

'A pox on you, dear dad,' Fenwick murmured, making a lewd gesture towards the sky. 'Look at who's a trained Fixer, observing all manner of Monster and amounting to lots.'

Fenwick's dad, deceased for twenty years, had no reply to offer. But the wind answered by rustling a tree branch and knocking a dead leaf astray. The leaf fell slowly, finally settling on the collection of homemade knives that Fenwick always kept on his belt. With an over-elaborate motion, Fenwick put his spyglass away, unsheathed a dagger, and stabbed the leaf, rotating it to study its brittle veins. Raine probably would have something to say about the thing's colour, or maybe Sibylle would murmur a mysterious quote on Fate's autumnal patterns.

'Alas, little leaf, all I can offer you is silver tongued chatter and a sharp point,' Fenwick announced, once again falling victim to his habit of talking to himself when nobody was looking.

Exercising his way with words – and the occasional homemade weapon – had been a necessity since boyhood. A terrible father and a life on the bleakest alleyways of Moltiers had made such knowledge necessary. By the time he turned sixteen, Fenwick had run away from home and used his silver tongue to find gang work, trafficking stolen armaments banned for civilian usage. By the time he was twenty, he'd developed a way with crafting and figured out how to jury-rig a crossbow with a magnifying glass to make it easier to aim. Smugglers liked him for his know-how, and the discreet network of Barbecian rogues who'd embarked on a similar path told him he couldn't escape this life, even though he increasingly wanted to. Then the Forked Vipers had tasked him to build an 'inescapable' cage for transporting poached birds of prey.

'You said I'd never amount to anything as well, you irascible old goat,' Fenwick said to the leaf, imagining the scorn-filled face of Judge Montagne, who had condemned him to eight years in Denvaux Prison. This was after the job had gone south. Fenwick had been too slow when it came to transporting the merchandise, and the Moltiers gendarmerie were surprisingly capable that day. At least in the end, he'd made the split-second decision to smash the cage he'd begrudgingly built, freeing those silver-winged birds of prey instead of delivering them to either the Vipers or the gendarmerie. After so many years taking orders from brutes who'd made him craft some truly wretched things, it had felt good to do that.

Then Denvaux spat Fenwick out, and there was no work to be found, neither normal nor illicit. No tradesman or machinist would hire a felon who had worked for poachers, and even Fenwick's network of ne'er-do-wells wouldn't have him back. He'd bungled the Forked Vipers deal, after all. Those days had been awful ones, with Fenwick cursing society (and Fate, even though he was only religious when convenient) on an hourly basis until a Guardian named Berenger paid him a surprise visit.

'Now I can't say I approve of your sordid past, sir,' Berenger had said. 'But the Institute is often in need of fellows with...unique skills. And besides, I heard you let those Creatures go! We'll make a Chronicler out of you yet, friend!'

It had been many seasons since that visit. These days, Fenwick worked alongside Berenger, who was truly a righteous – yet oddly endearing – pain in the rear. Second chances were rare; if you missed with a knife, you typically never had the opportunity to toss it again. Miraculously, a second chance had come Fenwick's way, after the world had placed him in cage after cage, over and over again.

'Those birds were in my cage,' Fenwick mused, remembering. 'It felt good to undo that.'

A beast darted across the clearing just then. Fenwick grinned and retrieved the whistle-like gadget he'd assembled from a flute and a series of watch gears. He blew it, and a low owl's hoot sounded to alert the others.

It was time to go to work.

Fixer

Whether it's finding a spare lens for your telescope, putting together a pulley system to lower friends down a cliff face, or smoothing over social situations in foreign regions, Fixers are the ones to call. Some Fixers emerge from the very poorest of Ecumene's peoples, never forgetting the struggles needed to get by in daily life. Others are fascinated by machinery and the way things work, staring up at the tallest buildings in wonder. Others still are silver-tongued, practising the social arts and learning all there is to know about the peoples of the world.

Fixers are renowned for their prowess with words, people, and things. Characterised by an inventiveness, resourcefulness, and a dedication to improving the world around them, Fixers embody the concepts of solidarity, quick-thinking, and self-reliance found at the core of Mappa Mundi's mission.

If you're a Fixer, you might...

- Delight in recognising social cues from both people, Monsters, and Creatures.
- Instantly know how to jury-rig tools, traps, and other implements to help your friends navigate a tough spot.
- Serve as both the charismatic face and improvisational mastermind for your fellow Chroniclers.

Training

Fixers have **Strength** in Deduction and **Weakness** in Traversal

Starting Skills

Choose two **Deduction Skills**, one **Exploration Skill**, and one **Observation Skill** from the Fixer Skill Path Starting Skills.

Starting Interactions

Choose three from the following: **Bait**; **Gift**; **Provoke**; **Read**; **Touch**

Specialisations

Envoy - Fabricator - Scavenger

Full descriptions of each Specialisation can be found on page 40.

Endorsements

Engineer - Medic - Conjurer

Full descriptions of each Endorsement can be found on page 41.



Fixer Specialisations

Envoy

A well-placed word whispered into the right ear, the correct number of coins swept across a palm, or the right secret kept safe can grease the wheels of power. Mappa Mundi Envoys have dedicated themselves to the study of social arts from across the known world, and their knowledge is a boon to any party.

Rewards: When this Specialisation is unlocked, make a choice: either immediately upgrade one Chronicler's Deduction die, or give each Chronicler a +1 to all Deduction Checks in relation to NPCs when the Envoy is present.



Fabricator

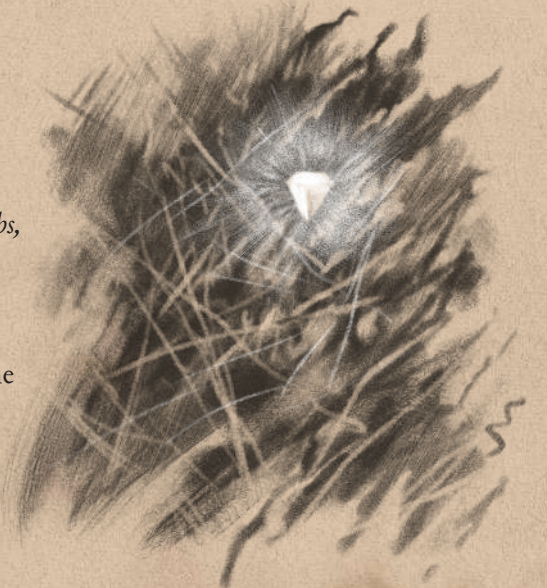
Some Chroniclers join the Mappa Mundi Institute for the opportunity to create and test their creations in the wide world. Fabricators are the hammering heart of the Mappa Mundi mission, and tools, equipment, clothing, and even machines are all in their remit and part of their skillset.

Rewards: Once per Chapter, a Fabricator may spend two Fate Points to create a tool that will assist them in passing a particular Check. This tool is kept by the Fabricator for the remainder of their journey through the Wilds and may be used whenever relevant to make a challenge easier to overcome.

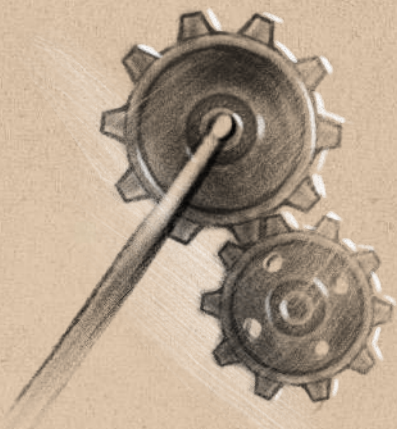
Scavenger

One person's trash is another person's treasure, they say. Scavengers prefer to think about the process another way: each and every thing has an essence, and that essence should be respected through use. Whether it is seeking out rare herbs, lost valuables, or hidden knowledge, a Scavenger will get the job done.

Rewards: When this Specialisation is unlocked, the Scavenger gains the **Take Samples Interaction** if not already unlocked. Once per Chapter, the Scavenger may spend a Fate Point for free, or may add one Fate Point spent by another Chronicler to their total.



Fixer Endorsements



Engineer

Requires Fabricator Specialisation and any Archivist Specialisation

Engineers are masters of mechanical workings. Combining their natural knack for building with an Archivist's keen skill at gathering all there is to know about fixing or maintaining machinery, buildings, or vehicles, Engineers are unsurpassed when it comes to technology.

Rewards: Chroniclers with this Endorsement do not need to make Checks in relation to machinery, vehicles, or tools. When these categories are used during Interactions, all Chroniclers in the party gain +2 to relevant Checks.

Medic

Requires any Fixer Specialisation and Guardian - Warden Specialisation

Any Fixer can explain the basic fundamentals of machines and contraptions. Some, though, have a mind for things with a mind of their own. The best thing about being a medic? The patient can tell you what hurts, at least most of the time. Medics have taken their first aid training to the next level and can turn their hand to most kinds of human injury and illness.

Rewards: When this Endorsement is unlocked, the Chronicler gains the **Diagnose** and **Treat/Heal Interactions** if not already unlocked. Whenever a Chronicler or NPC suffers an injury or sickness, reduce the effect by one level.

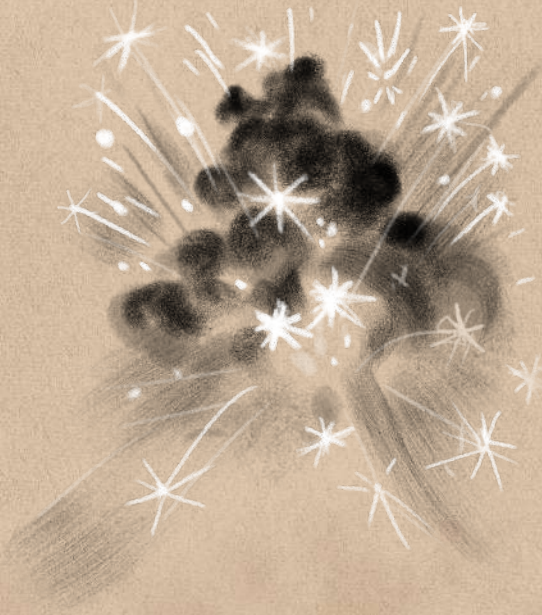


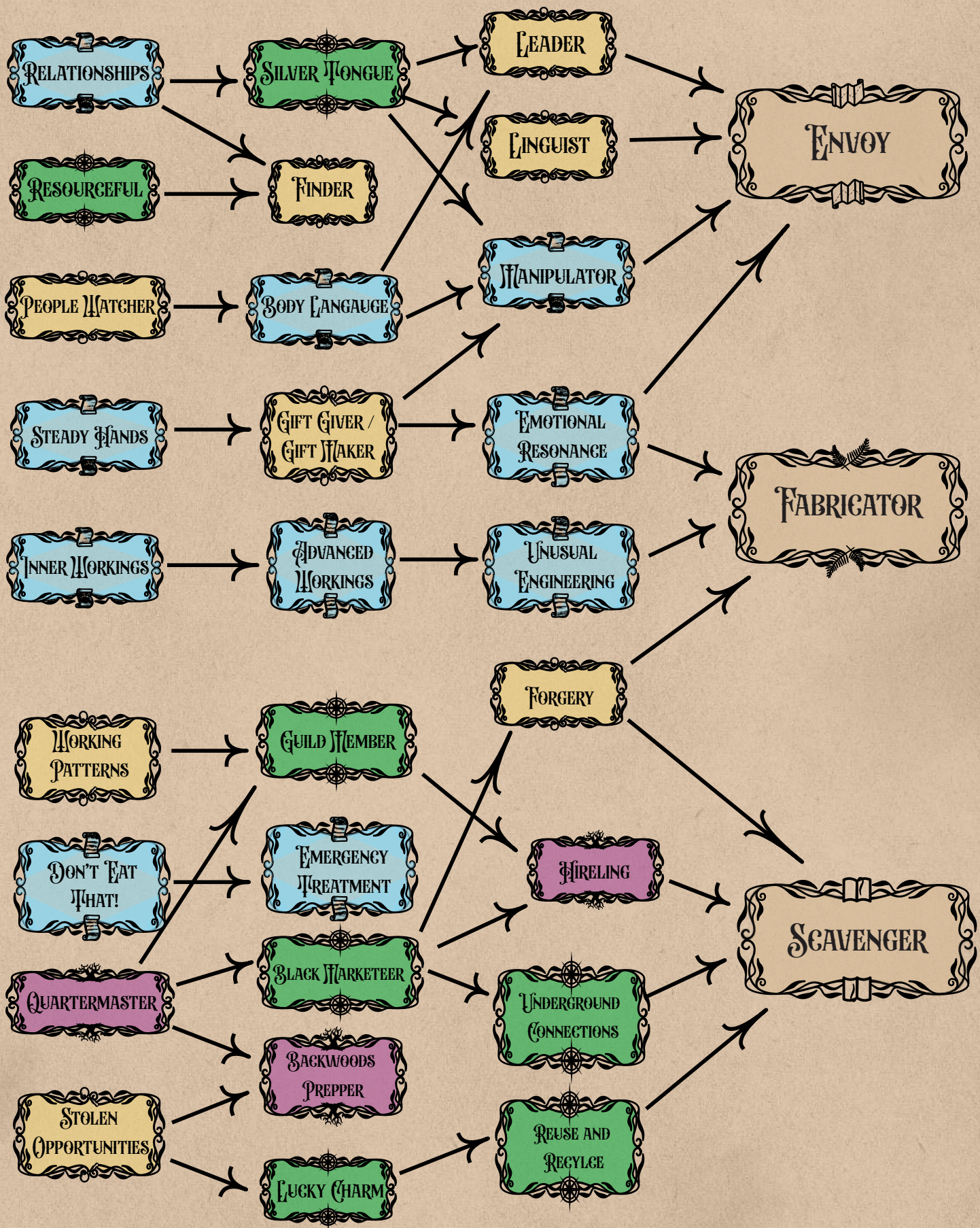
Conjurer

Requires any Fixer Specialisation and Diviner - Cartomancer Specialisation

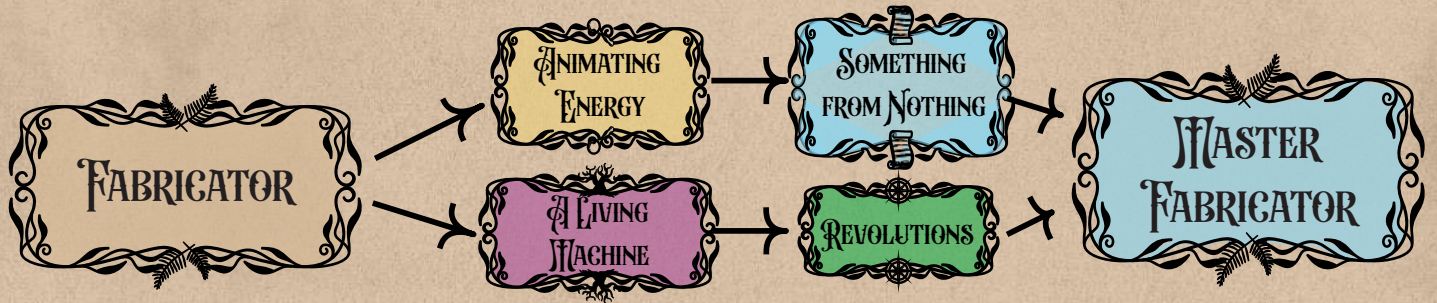
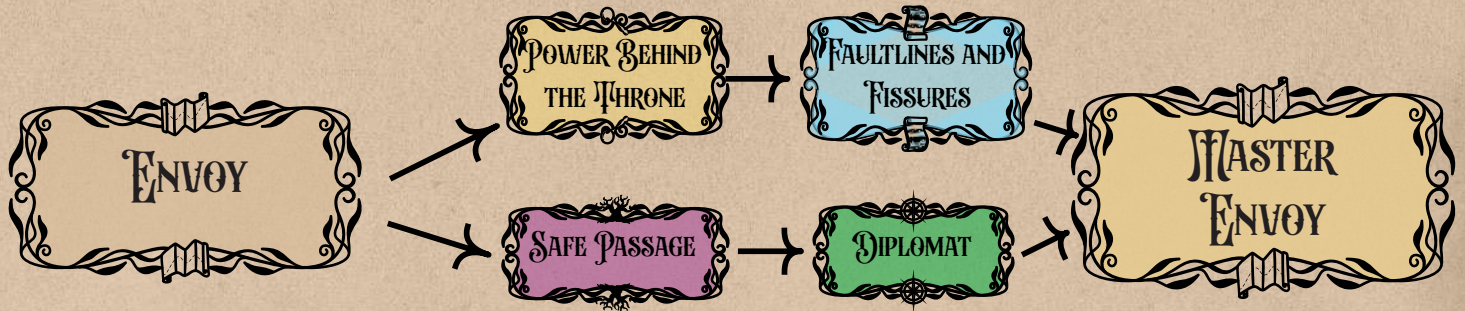
Tricking people is an art, but sometimes all you need to do it is a set of cards that pops out of a hidden mechanism you've built in your sleeve. Conjurers combine Fabricator know-how with a Cartomancer's skill at divination to conjure disarming gimmicks that affect all around them, both physically and mentally.

Rewards: When this Endorsement is unlocked, the Chronicler gains access to the **Distract Interaction**. Unique to this Endorsement, **Distract** allows the Conjurer to draw attention to themselves or otherwise mislead a target. This Interaction is not linked to any Behaviours, but can be used in relation to Monsters, Creatures, and NPCs.





FIXER SKILL PATH



KEY:

OBSERVATION



EXPLORATION



DEDUCTION



TRAVERSAL





Fixer Starting Skills

Relationships [Deduction]

You are a keen scholar of human behaviour, and nowhere is that behaviour more interesting than in the politics of personal relationships, small towns, big cities, and entire regions. You can see how it all connects, and sometimes, it isn't very pretty.

Resourceful [Exploration]

When something needs fixing, you know how to get it done based on what is at hand. When someone is suffering from an issue, you can think up some advice to help alleviate it.

Given enough time, you can whip together a basic and functional solution to situations just a bit beyond the trivial, be it physical or social.

People Watcher [Observation]

You've been around people all your life, and seen all manner of tricks, ruses, and moments of touching honesty. This has stood you in good stead, teaching you how to read moods, truths, and falsehoods.

Steady Hands [Deduction]

Years of fiddling with objects – be they watches and clocks, axles and cogs, or books and bindings – have given you the steady hands necessary to start assembling or repairing just about anything, whether a mechanical contraption or a broken bone.

Inner Workings [Deduction]

You've spent your life watching craftspeople at their work, learning what you could before you began your own training. As such, you have a basic understanding of a certain craft, such as the creation of simple objects, mechanisms, or alchemical brews.

Working Patterns [Observation]

Each place has its own habits and routines that are, more often than not, followed by all around. You have a gift for spotting these routines, understanding when a place is working, and more crucially when it isn't.

Don't Eat That! [Deduction]

You have a good knowledge of both edible and poisonous foods found in your home region, meaning you can give those mushrooms that might spoil your day a wide berth.

Quartermaster [Traversal]

No trip into the Wilds is safe without proper preparation. You can be relied upon to have properly provisioned

yourself for excursions beyond the walls and fences of towns and villages, or, at the very least, to be able to find some victuals out in the field.

Stolen Opportunities [Observation]

Treasure is synonymous with opportunity in your mind. You have a keen eye for treasures of all kinds, and always know the right opportunity to pilfer something you'll inevitably make use of later.

Fixer Level One Skills

Silver Tongue [Exploration]

Some use brawn to get their way, and some use cunning. For you, your words are the ticket that helps you move through the world. The right words in the right ear, and any door can open.

Finder [Observation]

Everyone in this world is looking for something, whether they know it or not. And you? You are good at finding the things people are looking for: goods, information, or people. And there is great power, and no small amount of profit, to be had for someone who knows how to find something.

Body Language [Deduction]

More important than the things someone says are the things they don't say, or the way they do or don't say them. You have studied body language and can usually tell when someone is hiding something.

Gift Giver [Observation]

Many a relationship has been formed, or a conflict resolved, by the giving of gifts. But this practice isn't as simple as it might appear. Knowing which gift to give, whom to give it to, and when is a vital skill and one you have honed over time.

Gift Maker [Observation]

The perfect gift can end a war, or start one. You have dedicated your creative energies to the creation of gifts. In a world where the practical is often the first and last consideration, time spent creating something of value that is of no use beyond itself is a noble pursuit.

Advanced Workings [Deduction]

You have spent time practising your chosen craft and can be relied upon to speak with authority on matters concerning it. You can even provide a basic level of training for others in your field.

— **Guild Member [Exploration]** —

Commerce, training, and protection: these are the things the trade guilds offer to their members. As a valued guild member, you will find both a bed and assistance anywhere your guild's presence is to be found.

— **Emergency Treatment [Deduction]** —

Depending on how you think about them, humans and machinery aren't really too dissimilar. Setting a lever isn't radically different from setting a bone. Right? Here, bite down on this.

— **Black Marketeer [Exploration]** —

There are common goods and there are rare goods. There are also legal goods and, shall we say, less-than-legal goods. You know the signs to follow to find the latter category, and the people who sell them.

— **Backwoods Prepper [Traversal]** —

Survival in the Wilds revolves around being prepared for the worst. You have taken this message to heart and ensure that you always have what you and your companions will need to get by in the Wilds, regardless of the dangers you might face.

— **Lucky Charm [Exploration]** —

Everyone needs a little bit of luck to get by in the world, and you're luckier than most. Your good luck charm seems to make Fate more kindly disposed to you, and you aren't going to turn down that kind of help!

Fixer Level Two Skills

— **Leader [Observation]** —

Few rise to the challenge of leadership; the world, after all, is full of unqualified, unsuitable leaders. But in all walks of life, leaders are born, leaders are made, and some take that step forward where others will not. You are one of those few, able to inspire confidence in those around you.

— **Linguist [Observation]** —

A talent for languages is perhaps one of the best gifts a Chronicler can possess, making travel through the Wilds and regions of Ecumene that much smoother. You have dedicated yourself to studying the world's many languages, allowing you to speak to and understand a diverse range of people more easily.

— **Manipulator [Deduction]** —

Most people are predictable. They follow certain habits, rules, and customs. This predictability makes them easier to understand and, to the right person, easier to steer. As a student in the subtle art of manipulation, you can use these behaviours to your advantage.

— **Emotional Resonance [Deduction]** —

Things are containers for feeling and emotion. Nowhere is this more true, in the customs of Ecumene, than in each person's collection of Bones. But other objects and items absorb traces of emotion, too, through long use or moments of heightened feelings. By studying an object, you are able to read it, to feel this emotional resonance, and draw conclusions from it.

— **Unusual Engineering [Deduction]** —

Some machines are designed to confuse an observer, with hidden mechanisms, processes that seem to lead in strange directions, and outcomes that don't match inputs. However, with the right eye and the right mind, even the most devilish of inventions can be puzzled out!

— **Forgery [Observation]** —

Sometimes you need the right documentation to smooth the way. It could be a ticket, an identity document, or a certificate of origin. Whatever it is, you can turn your hand to copying it.

— **Hireling [Traversal]** —

For the right price, you can usually find someone to do those tasks you just don't want (or can't) do for yourself. Whether it's running errands, fetching and carrying, or gathering information, you know where to find people to get things done for you.

— **Underground Connections [Exploration]** —

Moving in certain circles and trading in certain goods often draws the attention of a certain group of people who might work on the shadier side of the law. These people, if you know how to find them, can come in very useful, and you happen to know where they meet.

— **Reuse and Recycle [Exploration]** —

Life is tough, and for those travelling the Wilds, coming by useful objects and items is even tougher. But you've learned how to make use of those things others might throw away, or at least to find additional ways of using something that seems to be used up.



Envoy Skills

Power Behind the Throne [Observation]

Leaders do not get to where they are on their own. Frequently, they are the most charismatic or the most brutal, not the most capable. What they each have in common is a confidant, a fixer, the power behind the throne. The person doing their thinking for them. You have walked the corridors of power, and you know the levers that need to be pulled to get the outcome you desire.

Faultlines and Fissures [Deduction]

Society is an edifice, a smokescreen, a painted set in front of which the actors play. Or so the cynical view runs. Society is a brick wall, a pyramid, a road that winds in the direction of progress. Each person adds their own brick, but even the greatest craftspeople leave flaws behind them. You might not be good with your hands, but you can see and have a mind to explore these imperfections.

Safe Passage [Traversal]

You have talked yourself into and out of more places than most can imagine. Documents have been obtained, legally or otherwise, and once or twice you even managed to convince someone to carry your luggage for you. Travel is easy when you know how. You are adept at negotiating even the most difficult of terrain. After all, climbing a mountain is easier than talking your way into a palace!

Diplomat [Exploration]

If you leave one mark on the world before you hang up your cloak, it will be to have left it more connected than you found it. Travel broadens the mind, and in a world that very nearly lost itself, you have soaked up every experience you can. You honour the traditions of others by engaging openly and sharing them with those you meet next. The world needs connection, and you are a thread.

Master Envoy [Observation]

The world is miscommunication, a lost letter, a harsh word. The world is difference and division, dissatisfaction and disrepute. The world is the lost being led by the strong. The world, as you know, is more. The world is friendship, collaboration, community.

Fabricator Skills

Animating Energy [Observation]

It's a wonderful thing, seeing the contraption you've worked so hard on jolt, judder, or shudder to life. Whether by steam, clockwork, or just good old fashioned human exertion, a machine hums and revels in its newly gained power. People, you've noticed, are like this too. Too often we resemble automata. But that animating energy, that touch you have, brings others to life.

Something from Nothing [Deduction]

You have a rare talent, one that relies on seeing the world in a different way to most. When confronted with a problem, your instinct is to remove the problem, rather than seeking a way around it. And in those situations where most would see nothing to help, you see endless potential. They still tell stories about the time you found your way out of a locked pantry without opening the door.

A Living Machine [Traversal]

The mechanically minded focus on fixity. Machines and tools are simple enough; make the right connections or find the flaw and things will go on much as they did before. The Wilds have a mind of their own, but your journeys have shown that, like a machine, they operate according to patterns and a logic all their own. If you can decipher that, the challenge of travel is easier to overcome.

Revolutions [Exploration]

The turn of a wheel, the swing of a hammer, the completion of a plan: all are needed to bring about a revolution. Your journeys have exposed you to ways of doing and being that had never occurred to you before, along with experiences that have no names. You carry this fervour with you wherever you go as a spark of joy, and sparks help ignite fires in all kinds of places.

Master Fabricator [Deduction]

The world is wood and iron, parts separated from the whole. The world is unshaped, broken, beyond use. The world is ignorance fumbling in the darkness, a light extinguished. The world, as you know, is more. The world is invention, innovation, shaped by human hands.

Scavenger Skills

— All That Glimmers [Observation] —

You are someone who sees the value in things left behind or cast aside. 'Not all that glimmers is gold!' your parents said to you. 'Gold is not the only glimmer worth finding,' you'd think. This has served you well on your journeys. You've found things far more valuable. An empty eggshell, the last home of a new life; a nest still warm; a safe haven in a storm. You have an eye for value. Don't forget it.

— Finder of Lost Things [Deduction] —

Most associate loss with the tangible: an item, a person, a possession. But to focus on things is to lack perspective. A secret told is a secret lost. Trust broken is trust lost. Loss, while sometimes necessary, is always painful. You have a sense of lost things, and can see the weight loss puts on people. Often, it is those who have lost who need to be found. You know where to find them, and what they need.

— Better Than Nothing [Traversal] —

Too many who have tried to find themselves in the Wilds have been lost to starvation, dehydration, or exposure. You have been close to this yourself, have seen your companions delirious due to thirst and heat, hunger and cold. But you know that something is always better than nothing; the choice to starve is no choice at all. When it matters most, you know you'll find something out in the Wilds.

— The Marrow of Life [Exploration] —

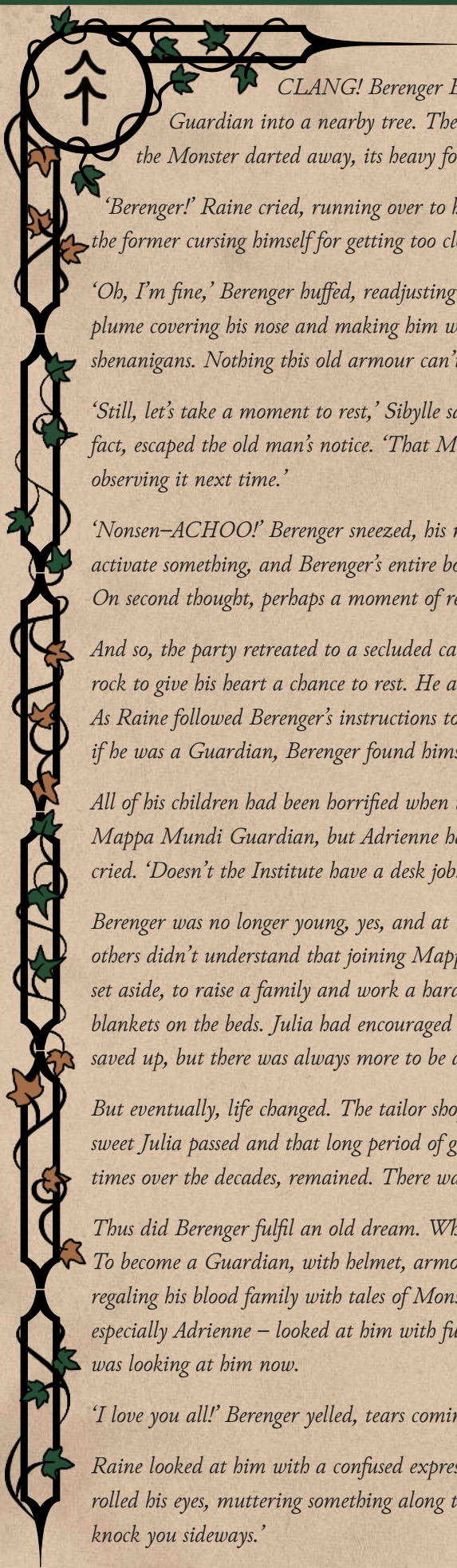
You came up hard. Some would say that you spent more time on the bones of your arse than off them. But even when you and those around you had nothing, there was always each other. There was experience, the stuff of life.

You have scavenged everything from the experiences encountered on your journeys, and these experiences are yours to share. A story is a thing, and it is precious.

— Master Scavenger [Exploration] —

The world is a rubbish dump, a charnel pit, the leavings from the table. The world is a scrabble in the mud, the pangs of hunger. The world is loose clothes, rags draped over a skeleton. The world, as you know, is more than this. The world is solidarity, giving and receiving, a trial by fire.





CLANG! Berenger Barrere's armour vibrated as the shaggy mass dashed against it, pushing the Guardian into a nearby tree. The next thing he knew, he was looking up at the stars. With a series of guttural cries, the Monster darted away, its heavy footfalls echoing along the forest floor.

'Berenger!' Raine cried, running over to his side and helping him upright. Fenwick and Sibylle were with her in an instant, the former cursing himself for getting too close to the beast and the latter thanking Fate that its reaction hadn't been worse.

'Oh, I'm fine,' Berenger buffed, readjusting his helmet, which had become twisted in an odd direction after his fall, with the plume covering his nose and making him want to sneeze. 'By Fate, I doubt there's even a flesh wound! Mere topsy-turvy shenanigans. Nothing this old armour can't take!'

'Still, let's take a moment to rest,' Sibylle said, as Raine insisted on inspecting Berenger all over to see if flesh wounds had, in fact, escaped the old man's notice. 'That Monster was very unpredictable. I can consult the cards to find a safer way of observing it next time.'

'Nonsen-ACHOO!' Berenger sneezed, his nose giving in to the dreadful machinations of the plume. The sneeze seemed to activate something, and Berenger's entire body ached. His heartbeat also quickened, which was never a good sign. 'Well... On second thought, perhaps a moment of respite isn't a shoddy idea.'

And so, the party retreated to a secluded cave a few feet away. Under Raine and Fenwick's strict orders, Berenger sat on a rock to give his heart a chance to rest. He also removed his armour and found a nasty purple mark spreading on his left arm. As Raine followed Berenger's instructions to dress the bruise with a poultice, telling him that he still needed to be careful even if he was a Guardian, Berenger found himself seeing the face of Adrienne.

All of his children had been horrified when their father – now a grandfather of seven small ones – decided to become a Mappa Mundi Guardian, but Adrienne had chided him the most. 'Why must you throw yourself in the line of danger?' she cried. 'Doesn't the Institute have a desk job? You're not a young man anymore!'

Berenger was no longer young, yes, and at 70 he was in fact the oldest Guardian the Institute had. But Adrienne and the others didn't understand that joining Mappa Mundi was a dream he'd fallen in love with as a young man. A dream he had set aside, to raise a family and work a hard job that raked in the bezants needed to keep stew on the table and warm blankets on the beds. Julia had encouraged him at times to try applying to Mappa Mundi, saying that they had enough coin saved up, but there was always more to be done. The work of being a tailor, a father, and a husband. Dreams could wait.

But eventually, life changed. The tailor shop was sold off. The children became busy with families of their own. And when sweet Julia passed and that long period of grieving had finally lessened, her gentle words of encouragement, echoed at sporadic times over the decades, remained. There was no longer any reason to wait.

Thus did Berenger fulfil an old dream. While he could have been a Fixer, there was only one thing his younger self desired. To become a Guardian, with helmet, armour, and staff. To protect. And here he was. Protecting a found family, and regaling his blood family with tales of Monsters and treks across the world. The grandchildren ate it up. The older children – especially Adrienne – looked at him with furrowed brows and concern, telling him to please be careful. Much like how Raine was looking at him now.

'I love you all!' Berenger yelled, tears coming to his eyes. 'Fate knock me sideways; it feels good to protect you.'

Raine looked at him with a confused expression, while Sibylle jumped and dropped her cards at the loud shout. Fenwick rolled his eyes, muttering something along the lines of, 'I don't know how to break it to you, my friend, but Fate really did knock you sideways.'

If his heart gave out tonight, Berenger thought, it would be a good death. This was where he belonged.

Guardian

Greeneyed, some call them. Wildspeaker, say others. Deepseeker, they whisper. Everyone has a touch of the Wilds about them, though some feel that touch more deeply. Among those rarer few are those who form the ranks of the Guardians. Many have come from rural areas where they grew up immersed in the greens, golds, whites, and browns of diverse habitats. Others heard nothing but footsteps on cobblestones and yearn for the deep solitude of the Wilds. And some have dedicated themselves to the study and protection of select Monsters, Creatures, people, or habitats.

Guardians are a party's protectors, trackers, and guides. Defined by a caring soul, a love of adventure, and a desire to see all life flourish, those who choose the Guardian's path represent the strength and compassion at the core of the Mappa Mundi mission.

If you're a Guardian, you might...

- Regularly practise with shield, staff, and other tools to defend both your comrades from Monsters, and Monsters from humans who might needlessly harm them.
- Always be the first into new situations, getting up close and personal with the dangers and mysteries of the world.
- Act as a sturdy bulwark on the trail, keeping your fellow Chroniclers from harm's way.

Training

Guardians have **Strength** in Traversal and **Weakness** in Deduction

Starting Skills

Choose two **Traversal Skills**, one **Exploration Skill**, and one **Observation Skill** from the Guardian Skill Path Starting Skills

Starting Interactions

Choose three from the following: **Explore**; **Feed**; **Play**; **Protect**; **Provoke**

Specialisations

Warden - **Survivalist** - **Trapper**

Full descriptions of each Specialisation can be found on page 50.

Endorsements

Veterinarian - **Herbalist** - **Fatekeeper**

Full descriptions of each Endorsement can be found on page 51.



Guardian Specialisations

Warden

Giving their bodies and soul to their cause, Wardens are brave vagabonds who armour themselves to safeguard the vulnerability and fragility of nature. Some are dedicated to an entire region, others to a single stand of trees. Some keep vigil over the habitats of specific Monsters, others wander the Wilds offering assistance where it is required. All are dedicated protectors and stewards of life.

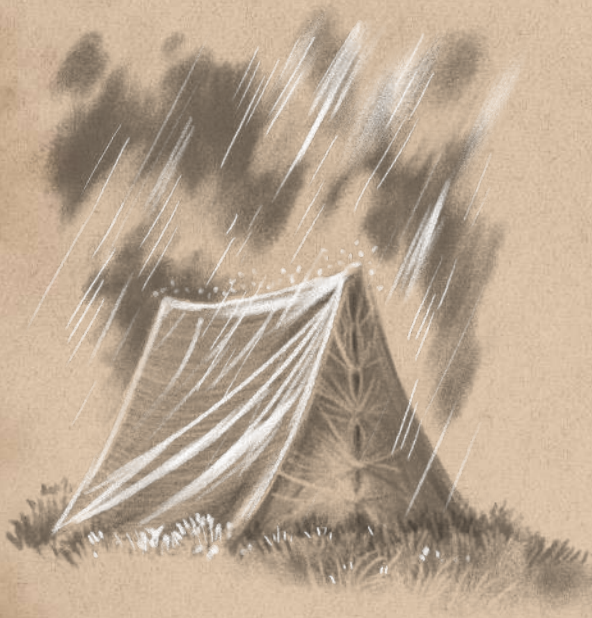
Rewards: Wardens may choose a Creature companion to accompany them on their journeys. Most Wardens choose a dog or a bird, specially trained by the Mappa Mundi Institute, but others have been known to bond with rarer Creatures. This companion may be granted one Traversal or one Exploration Skill from any Skill Path.



Survivalist

Surviving in the Wilds is no mean feat. Monsters, Creatures, and even people are all potentially hostile to intrusion and strangeness. A sun-dappled landscape can become a storm-wracked tempest in no time at all, and food and shelter are always at a premium. For the Survivalist, it is not the Wilds that need to be tamed, but their own nature. For when you become one with the Wilds, an integral part of the ecosystem, the bounty of life is given to you.

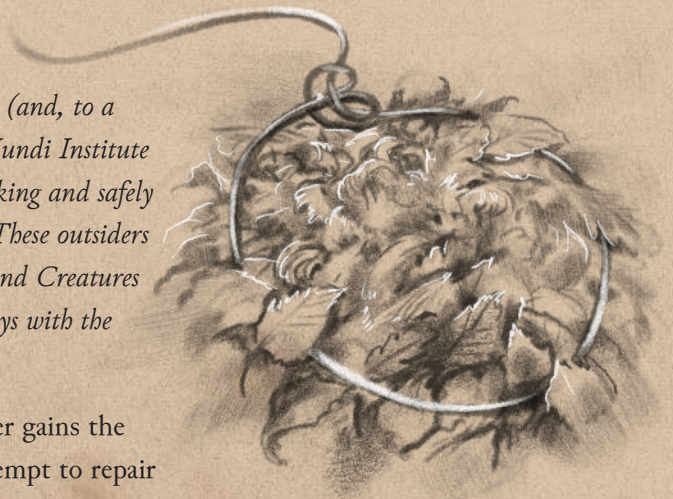
Rewards: When this Specialisation is unlocked, make a choice: either immediately upgrade one Chronicler's Traversal die, or give each Chronicler in the party a +1 to all Traversal Checks while the Survivalist is present.



Trapper

Many across Ecumene believe that killing or harming Monsters (and, to a lesser extent, Creatures) is a terrible offence, and the Mappa Mundi Institute shares this belief. However, a rare few, skilled in the arts of tracking and safely securing living beings, are given the right to work as Trappers. These outsiders use their skills to protect and preserve life, relocating Monsters and Creatures who pose a threat or are threatened by human settlements, always with the Guardian's oath firmly in mind.

Rewards: When this Specialisation is unlocked, the Trapper gains the **Subdue Interaction**. If already unlocked, any successful attempt to repair a Frayed Thread results in two Threads being repaired.



Guardian Endorsements



Veterinarian

Requires Guardian Specialisation and Archivist - Biologist Specialisation

Some Guardians possess the strong desire to heal and have combined the knowledge and learning of a Biologist with this need to provide aid. These Veterinarians train to administer medical care to a variety of different Monsters and Creatures in truly the noblest of pursuits.

Rewards: Chroniclers with this Endorsement gain access to the **Diagnose** and **Treat/Heal Interactions** if not already unlocked. Any successful use of these Interactions automatically repairs a Frayed Thread. Veterinarians may attempt to repair a Severed Thread by spending a Fate Point.

Herbalist

Requires Survivalist Specialisation and any Fixer Specialisation

Survivalists who develop a special focus on plants, flowers, trees, moss, and fungi, with the understanding that a healthy and diverse biome supports the Creatures and Monsters that live in an area, sometimes become Herbalists. Utilising the know-how of a Fixer, they seek out all manner of plant life, creating concoctions that can work miracles.

Rewards: Chroniclers with this Endorsement do not need to make Checks related to plants, herbs, or trees. This includes using the **Bait**, **Feed**, and **Take Samples Interactions** when related to one or more of these categories.

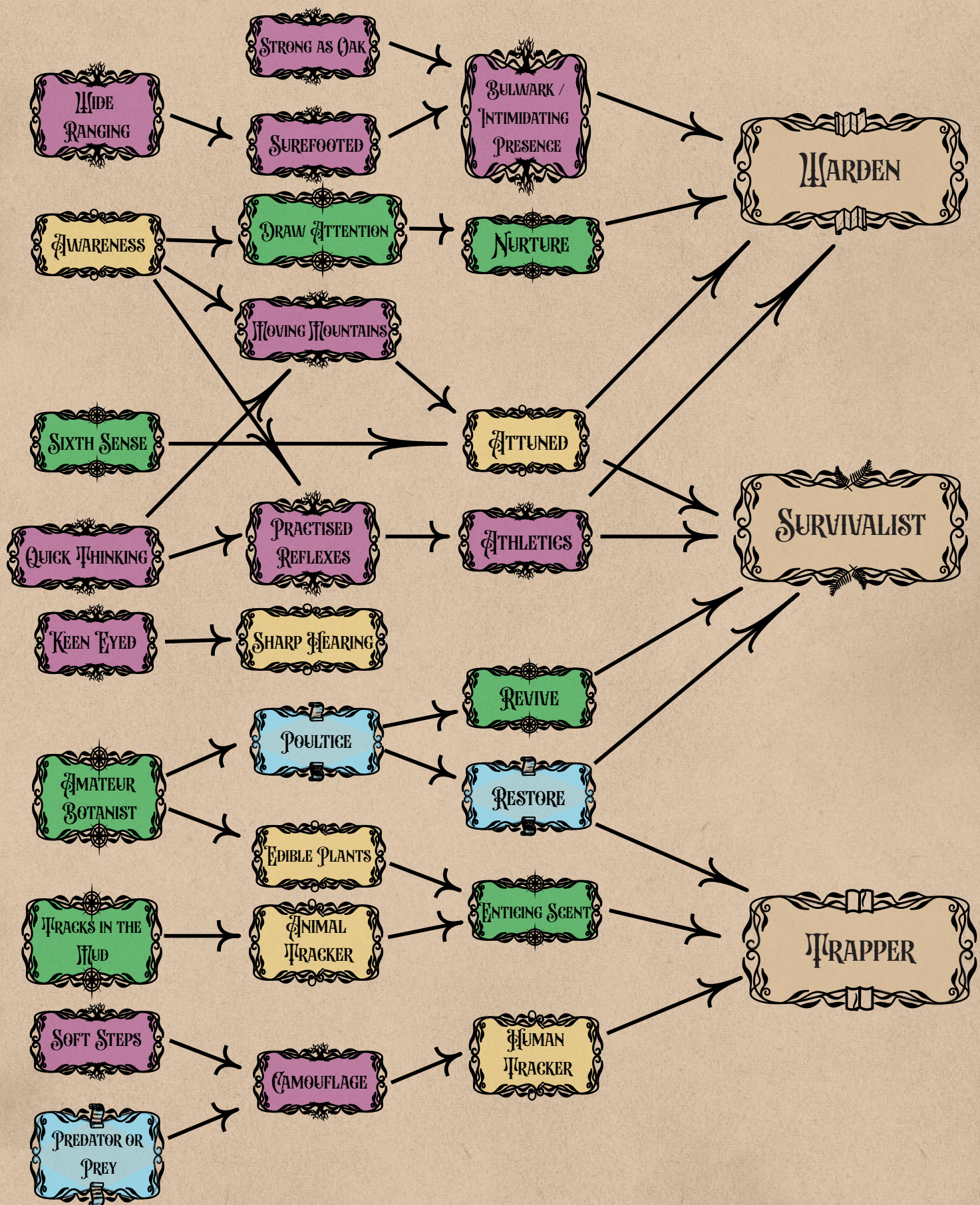


Fatekeeper

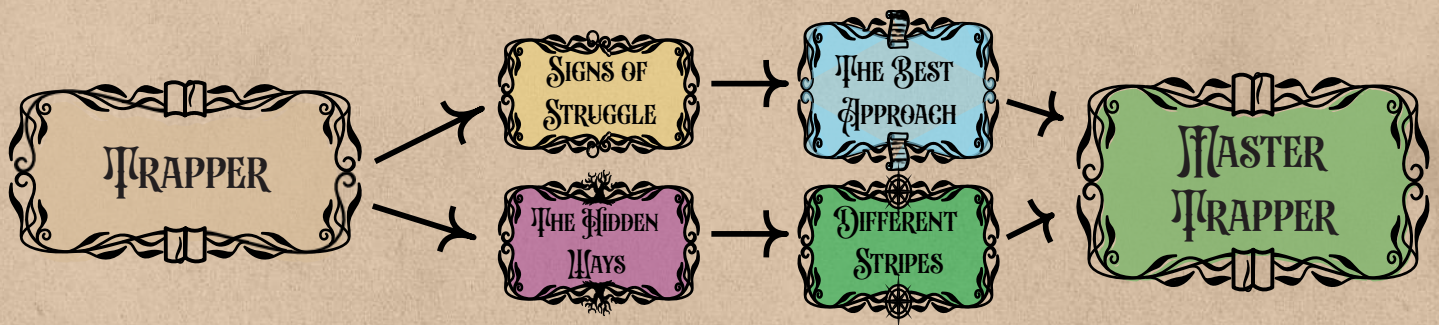
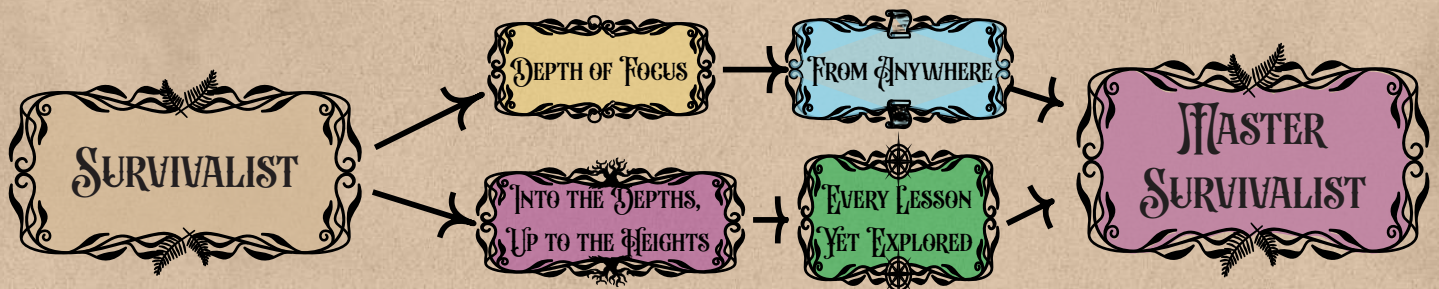
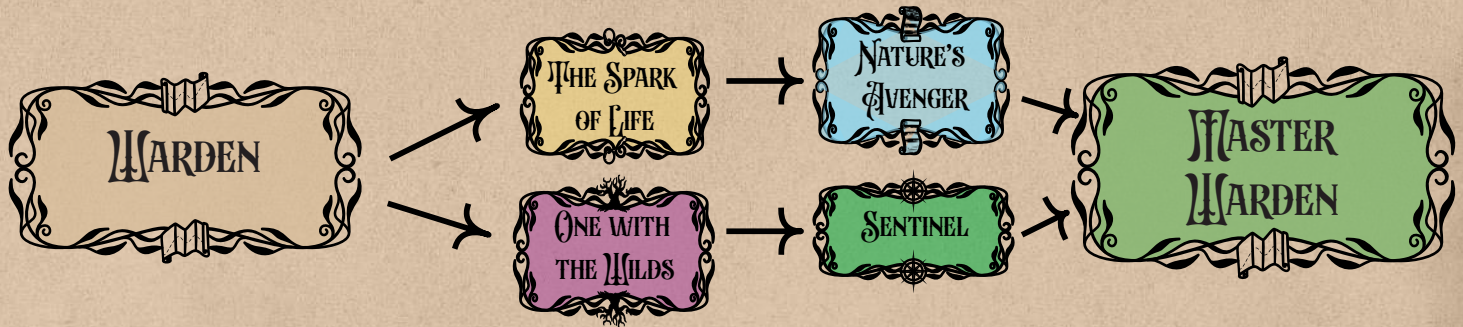
Requires Warden Specialisation and any Diviner Specialisation

Fatekeepers are Wardens who dabble with Divining and have given themselves up to the semi-religious notion that Ecumene's Monsters are incarnations of Fate. With shields at the ready, they swear oaths to become armoured vessels for the whims of Fate, chance, luck, and everything in between.

Rewards: Chroniclers with this Endorsement gain access to the **Commune Interaction** if not already unlocked. Whenever they spend a Fate Point in relation to a Monster or Creature, the result is automatically a success without the need to roll a Fate Check.



GUARDIAN SKILL PATH



KEY:

OBSERVATION

EXPLORATION

DEDUCTION

TRAVERSAL



Guardian Starting Skills

Wide Ranging [Traversal]

You have spent many hours roaming the terrain of your homeland and gained an affinity for moving beyond the sight of the most isolated villages. The secrets of the Wilds await your presence, and you're always looking beyond the horizon for new paths to blaze.

Awareness [Observation]

Keeping one's wits about them is vital for survival, whether one is in a city, a village, or deep in the mountains. Your mentor taught you that awareness, the honing of one's attention until it is as sharp as any blade, is a Guardian's very best protection.

Sixth Sense [Exploration]

When you were young, the Wilds called to you. Your sight, smell, hearing, touch, and even your taste registered this yearning. Now, your exposure to the Wilds has given you a sixth sense, allowing you to feel that which the Wilds feel.

Quick Thinking [Traversal]

Your athleticism and reflexes have made you adept at recognising hazards in the Wilds, making you a valuable travelling companion. More than once you've saved a comrade from a twisted ankle, or worse.

Keen Eyed [Traversal]

Most people filter out the details of the world around them, moving through life hardly seeing anything. But you know that there is much to be found where you least expect it.

Little flies past you, and details ranging from environmental hazards to potentially dangerous predators ring out in your brain regularly.

Amateur Botanist [Exploration]

During your training, you paid special attention to the lessons on the flora of your home region. As a result, you know which flowers, shrubs, and trees can offer aid and which ones spell poisonous harm.

Tracks in the Mud [Exploration]

You've got a keen eye for following a trail, whether through mud, sleet, or cobblestone. When you peer closely at tracks, sometimes you can even discern the physical state of the entity that left them behind.

Soft Steps [Traversal]

As you stalked cats, surprised dogs, and carefully inspected bird's nests in your youth, you became accustomed to

treading softly lest you reveal your presence to your target.

Despite whatever armour you might be wearing, it's unusually easy for you to creep close without alerting others to your presence.

Predator or Prey [Deduction]

Your dedication to the creatures of the Wilds is associated with one side of Fate's greatest dichotomy: predator or prey. This unusual affinity has inspired you to mimic the techniques of your chosen side, allowing you to take on the actions of a possible predator or a lowly prey to obtain subtle advantages in the field.

Guardian Level One Skills

Strong as Oak [Traversal]

Years of training with armour and shield have given you an impressively strong physique. Whether it's clearing a shrub-lined path, chopping down a rotting tree, or lifting a colossal boulder, you can be relied on when strength is needed to solve a situation.

Surefooted [Traversal]

Time spent in the Wilds is careful and attentive time. Those charging through the underbrush without choosing their steps with care will roll an ankle, and vulnerability can be quickly punished. You are practised and surefooted as a result of careful attention to your surroundings.

Draw Attention [Exploration]

Guardians are often an imposing presence in the field, though this isn't always related to their size. Even small and seemingly unimpressive Guardians radiate an energy that cannot be ignored. You may not speak very much, but when exploring the Wilds, you draw all eyes to you.

Moving Mountains [Traversal]

Most people aren't built for the Wilds. You, however, let the Wilds flow through you. When a drastic situation emerges that others think is just too difficult, chances are you can overcome it, either by sheer physical force or mental fortitude.

Practised Reflexes [Traversal]

You have spent hours, days, and months honing your skills to ensure you and your companions are as safe as can be during treks across rough terrain. The result? You can move and react with the speed of wild things, affording you a better chance to avoid danger.

— Sharp Hearing [Observation] —

The Monsters and Creatures of the Wilds use all of their senses to detect prey and avoid danger. While many humans only rely on their eyes, your experiences have taught you to stand still and hear the world around you.

— Poultice [Deduction] —

The Wilds are filled with herbs, mosses, and plants that can treat minor injuries and alleviate the symptoms of illness. This knowledge is vital for Guardians, who spend increasing amounts of time isolated and alone. The ability to treat pain and illness makes them essential to others.

— Edible Plants [Observation] —

Nature presents a bounty for those who know what they are looking for. While survival in the Wilds is difficult, those who find themselves short of food, or wanting to supplement their stores, must have knowledge of those plants that are edible. The particularly astute will also have studied the eating habits of Monsters and Creatures, and know which plants they prefer.

— Animal Tracker [Observation] —

Each Guardian interprets their duty differently. Some stand vigil over certain locations while others travel widely. You have chosen to track the Monsters and Creatures of the wild, developing your skills in stalking, observing, and documenting in case one of these living beings must be trapped for its own good.

— Camouflage [Traversal] —

You have spent time observing the hardest-to-find Monsters and Creatures of the Wilds, examining how they remain hidden from view. And you have adopted these skills for your own purposes, melting into the environment and avoiding those who seek you out.

Guardian Level Two Skills

— Bulwark [Traversal] —

A Guardian's training begins and ends with their shield and armour, and you take this one step further, turning yourself into an armoured human shield at a moment's notice. You're perfectly willing to throw your own body in harm's way to protect the lives and health of others.

— Intimidating Presence [Traversal] —

All Guardians, even the smallest, emanate an air of physical capability. And while they're committed to non-violence, they are not people you'd want to mess with. You

exhibit this to the fullest, radiating intimidation even from the tiniest of movements.

— Nurture [Exploration] —

All life follows the same stages: we are born, we grow, we live, we die. Rarely, though, is life as vulnerable as it is in its earliest forms. Your priority has always been to cherish and protect life in its first stages. You have a tendency to seek out, locate, and win the trust of youngsters – both human and otherwise.

— Attuned [Observation] —

When you quiet your mind, the Wilds fill it with images, sounds, scents, and tastes. You have become attuned to its ever-changing, always constant nature, and your sixth sense can tell you a myriad of different things if you just stop to listen to it.

— Athletics [Traversal] —

The terrain of the Wilds is ever-changing. Those travelling through it are called upon to ford rivers, climb mountains, scale cliffs, wade through swamps, and trudge through snow, among many other trials of endurance. Your rigorous training has given you the athletic skills required to overcome these difficulties.

— Revive [Exploration] —

Certain herbs, oils, and mixtures are known to have reviving powers, normally due to their strong (or foul) smell. You're skilled at locating these potent tools and are always the first to help an unconscious ally who needs a little pick-me-up.

— Restore [Deduction] —

Survival in the Wilds requires a knowledge of first aid, basic medicine, and the optimal way to treat injuries. You have spent time learning from healers of all types and are skilled enough to treat basic physical injuries.

— Enticing Scent [Exploration] —

Trackers know that it is often best to have your target come to you. To this end, each tracker learns the habits of their quarry, and can mix together plants, foods, and other substances to create alluring smells.

— Human Tracker [Observation] —

For most, the Wilds are a dangerous and forbidding place. To you, they are neither safe nor dangerous; they are what people make of them. More dangerous are those who seek to harm their sanctity. You are the Wilds' shield, and have learned to track those who would harm your sanctuary.



Warden Skills

— The Spark of Life [Observation] —

The Flux showed us that all life – even the oldest, strongest, most deeply rooted – dwells in the shadow of its own absence. You have seen its effects – of vibrancy, fecundity, and creation stripped away. But you have also seen the shoots of recovery, the spark of life always burning, incandescent even when most exposed. You have seen life reassert itself, and know how to nurture it.

— Nature's Avenger [Deduction] —

The thought – that someone would kill, would harm, would exploit the Wilds and those who call it home – gave you chills. The reality, you're afraid to admit, was far worse. Nothing could have prepared you for the things you have witnessed. But this knowledge has made you strong and steeled your conviction. You know those who inflicted this harm, and you know how to find them.

— One With The Wilds [Traversal] —

There is nothing you cannot be. You are earth, stone, mud, and dust. You are moss, leaves, bark, and branches. You are water, a ripple, a wave, the current. You are the wind, the sun and the sky, the shadow of clouds. The life of a Warden is one of total and absent impact. Of being seen and felt without being noticed. You are the living embodiment of the Wilds, able to move seamlessly within.

— Sentinel [Exploration] —

The Wilds are full of features that embody the principles of the sentinel. From broad and ancient oaks to titanic mountains and cliffs, cascading waterfalls to vast rivers holding the way against any incursion. You, the shield of the Wilds, can be counted among them. You are the gate, the wall, the bulwark against the harms that would befall the land. Stand strong, sentinel.

— Master Warden [Exploration] —

The world is dead, blood and bone splattered and smashed in the mud. The world is replete with danger, a threat to you and those you love. The world is an enemy, nemesis, fear in the dark. The world, as you know, is more. The world is a paradise, a gift, a treasure to be shared.

Survivalist Skills

— Depth of Focus [Observation] —

Survival requires a state of constant vigilance, especially when the safety of others rests in your hands. Some describe an awareness of danger as a sixth sense, as if from a mystical source. You know the answer is far more mundane. To anticipate danger, to survive in the Wilds, is a case of focus, practice, and dedication. You are attuned to the Wilds and can sense dangers long before others.

— From Anywhere [Deduction] —

The Wilds obey a logic all of their own. Those not used to these erratic patterns are prone to underestimate or fail to notice the signs around them. You have seen most of what the Wilds can throw at you, and this allows you to anticipate the scenarios you might encounter on your travels. Those who charge in often find themselves lost, injured, or worse. Not you, not here, not ever.

— Into the Depths, Up to the Heights [Traversal] —

No matter where you are, you always have your feet. No matter the height, you keep your head. No matter the depths and the darkness, your wits will not abandon you. You have travelled to places and seen sights that you could not ever have imagined before you started. And while the thought of hidden places motivates your every step, you know you'll be able to handle them when you find them.

— Every Lesson Yet Explored [Exploration] —

You know what you know, and you know what you don't. The Guardian's path is to forge ahead, to protect, to nurture and care. It is one of sacrifice of the self, of uplifting others at one's own expense. Your training was rigorous, but the most important lesson you learned was to listen: to others, to the Wilds, to your instincts. You have learned all you can from others, and this serves you well.

— Master Survivalist [Traversal] —

The world is a cliff, a precipice, the call of the void. The world is struggle and pain and confrontation. The world is a conflagration, a sickness, a shattered morass. The world, as you know, is more. The world is a rope, a bridge, a helping hand.

Trapper Skills

— Signs of Struggle [Observation] —

Those given the responsibilities of a Trapper by the Mappa Mundi Institute are deeply aware of the impact of their chosen path. It does not suffice to be skilled enough to find, track, and capture a living being. They must be focused, above all else, on the preservation of life. You exemplify this, and have spent hours studying Monster and Creature biology and knowing when they are in distress.

— The Best Approach [Deduction] —

Each being is unique. The patterns of its life, its behaviours, its interactions are always different, even subtly, from those around it. What works for one will not always work for another. You learned this lesson through practice and exposure. You know that approaching your target is rooted in respect, deference, and taking time to consider how best to achieve your goals.

— The Hidden Ways [Traversal] —

There are places that nobody knows, that no human has seen, places where no voice has pierced the silence of a thousand times a thousand years. These are places none will see, not even you. But the ways less taken, those reserved for Monsters and Creatures, can be found, and you know where to look. You have learned to find and walk these paths less seen, always in pursuit of your target.

— Different Stripes [Exploration] —

While others among your contemporaries have focused their energies on understanding the differences between peoples, or places, or environments, you have taken Monsters and Creatures as your object of study. Your travels have exposed you to non-human life in abundant variety, and you can be counted on to know and understand even the smallest of differences between them.

— Master Trapper [Exploration] —

The world is a snare, a pit, a goal, the pleas of a frightened captive. The world is restraint, restriction, opportunity lost and potential unreached. The world belongs to the strong, the uncaring. The world, as you know, is more. The world is aid offered, help accepted, and freedom realised.



Interactions

— Bait (Exploration) —

Experienced Chroniclers, usually those with Guardian Training, will know which foods will appeal to certain Monsters or Creatures. **Bait** is used to lure Monsters or Creatures into a location and keep them there for a while. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours such as eating and food habits, the bravery or timidity of a Monster or Creature, and sometimes a target's health.

— Commune (Deduction) —

It is the dream of most people to be able to talk with Monsters and Creatures. For most, this requires relying on body language. But for those particularly skilled or dedicated, it is possible to talk with non-human beings.

Commune is used to communicate in a non-verbal fashion. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours such as sentience. It can also be used to hold conversations and understand a being's motivations, beliefs, and desires.

— Diagnose (Observation) —

Death is part of Fate's design; eventually everyone's thread is severed and their essence returns to the earth. Illness and wounds are also parts of life, but they don't always lead to death. **Diagnose** is used to identify trauma in Monsters and Creatures. This Interaction will often reveal physical, psychological, or emotional Behaviours related to health and sickness, and sometimes treatment options.

— Explore (Exploration) —

Exploration is at the heart of the Mappa Mundi Institute's mission, for without the drive to leave the safety of hearth and home, few would undertake the monumental task of researching and writing a Chronicle. **Explore** is used to scout and experience the physical geography around a Monster or Creature, and might entail diving below the surface of a lake or delving deeper into a cave system to see what is hidden from view. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours related to habitat and lifestyle.

— Feed (Traversal/Exploration) —

Feed is an Interaction centred around the giving of food or sustenance. Where **Bait** is used to lure Monsters or Creatures into a situation, **Feed** is a more intimate act. Many Monsters, if calm enough, may accept an offering of

food put in front of them, but it is a rare and almost sacred experience to feed a Monster from the hand. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours related to feeding habits, friendliness, willingness to tolerate outsiders, and whether a target is community-minded or individualistic.

— Gift (Deduction) —

Monsters and Creatures have rich inner lives, and some may be covetous or easily flattered. **Gift** affords Chroniclers the opportunity to supply targets with things they want, desire, or covet. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours around cultural expectations, greed or asceticism, and purity of purpose.

— Play (Traversal/Exploration) —

Monsters, Creatures, and humans have many things that unite them, but the most fundamental experience that connects us all is **Play**. From the young to the old and all in between, playing is a universal experience and one that represents joy, learning, and social bonding. Though different beings will have different understandings of play, this Interaction will often reveal Behaviours around bonding and relationships, leisure time, and learning.

— Protect (Traversal) —

Monsters and Creatures are occasionally targets of violence. **Protect** allows Chroniclers to safeguard those suffering from threats and oppression. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours around aggression or passivity, the means by which a target can or will fight, and whether a target is predator or prey.

— Provoke (Traversal/Deduction) —

Though Mappa Mundi Chroniclers are sworn to protect the Monsters and Creatures of the world, on rare occasions, forceful measures are required. **Provoke** allows Chroniclers to obtain and secure the attention of a target, sometimes physically but also verbally or through other forms of distraction. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours around intelligence, fears, predator and prey relationships, and deeper understanding of human cultures.

— Read (Deduction) —

Those exposed to Monsters and Creatures for long periods of time begin to learn how to interpret their non-verbal forms of communication. Using **Read**, a Chronicler can determine a target's state of mind, its levels of comfort or fear, whether it is confident or shy, inquisitive or uninterested, and whether it poses a threat or is safe to approach. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours related to general feelings, general attitudes, and basic levels of safety.

— Sing (Exploration) —

Music suffuses the Wilds, from the songs of birds and the whistle of the wind to the gurgling of a river and the stir of leaves. Chroniclers gifted with clear voices are known to **Sing** to their targets as a form of communication, as a means of calming them down, or for the simple joy of it. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours related to communication, creativity, and enjoyment.

— Sketch (Observation) —

Some draw for fun, others to capture the world in novel and interesting ways. When Chroniclers take out their drawing tools and paper, it is usually to **Sketch** Monsters or Creatures. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours related to a target's physicality, including details that might otherwise be missed on first impression, such as the pattern of scales, the striations in feathers, or the unique functions of an eye.

— Soothe (Exploration) —

Comfort, they say, is one of the driving motivators. **Soothe** allows Chroniclers to provide emotional or social comfort to a target, calming them, reducing their distress, and encouraging them into a less frantic state of mind. This Interaction won't always reveal linked Behaviours, but will often allow Chroniclers to approach distressed targets. It is also very useful when attempting to repair Frayed Threads.

— Study (Observation) —

Study sees Chroniclers analysing and examining their targets over longer periods. Some have been known to embed themselves in the landscape, studying Monsters and Creatures for weeks or months at a time. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours unique to a given target.

— Subdue (Traversal) —

Sometimes, Monsters, Creatures, and people can become a threat to themselves or others. Whether driven by pain, anger, frustration, or hunger, qualified Chroniclers are required to step in to **Subdue** their target. This Interaction, which should be used sparingly and with caution, will often reveal Behaviours linked to defence and protection and allows Chroniclers to work more closely with potentially dangerous targets.

— Take Samples (Traversal) —

Nesting materials, feathers, lost teeth, shed skin, fallen scales, saliva, and even pieces of stool. **Take Samples** allows Chroniclers with an interest in the physical sciences to supplement their observations of Monster and Creature Behaviours with hard (or sometimes distressingly soft) evidence. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours linked to a target's physicality, habitat, diet, or appearance.

— Talk (Deduction) —

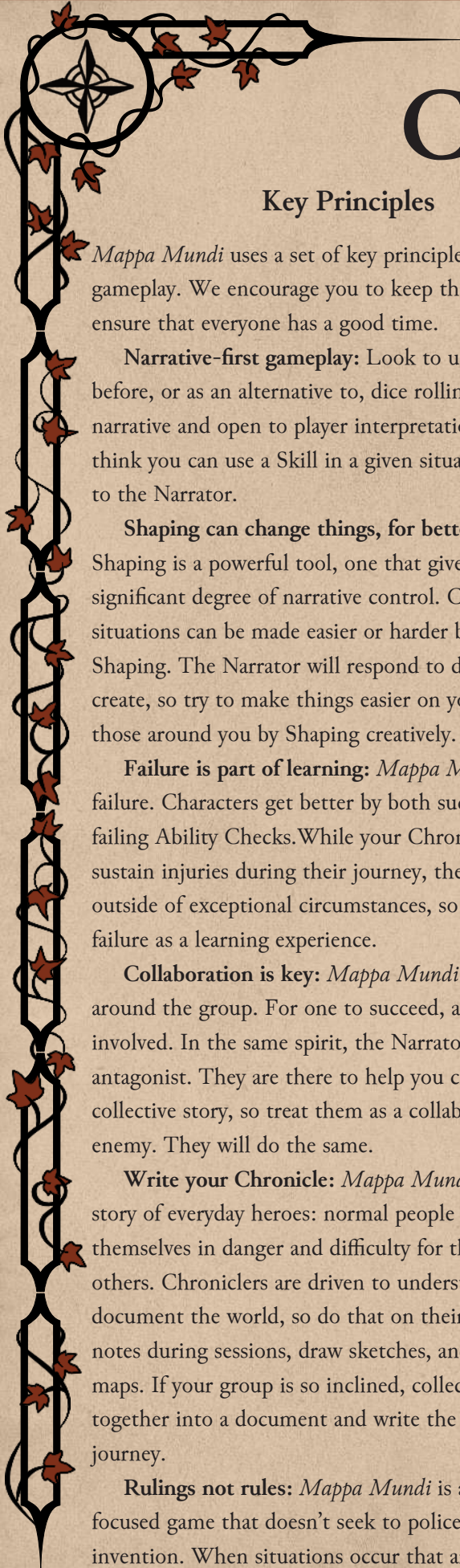
Any Chronicler who has spent time in the Wilds knows that Monster and Creature communication can take several forms. The truly knowledgeable will know that just because you cannot understand a language or form of communication doesn't mean that your interlocutor doesn't understand yours. To **Talk** seems simple, but can often be effective. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours linked to a target's wants, desires, thoughts, and opinions, and can also be used to bring calm to a situation.

— Touch (Traversal) —

Nothing compares to the thrill of close proximity. **Touch** allows Chroniclers to verify with their hands the information gathered by their eyes. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours linked to a target's physicality, but it is also linked to gaining trust or determining a target's safety or danger levels.

— Treat/Heal (Deduction/Observation) —

While some specialise in Diagnosis, others are skilled in practical applications of medical and veterinary knowledge. For those who get their hands into the problem, **Treat/Heal** allows Chroniclers to alleviate medical issues or wounds suffered by a Monster or Creature. This Interaction will often reveal Behaviours linked to a target's history and the risks it faces in the Wilds, though is most often used to repair Frayed Threads and gain trust.



Core Rules

Key Principles

Mappa Mundi uses a set of key principles to facilitate gameplay. We encourage you to keep them in mind to ensure that everyone has a good time.

Narrative-first gameplay: Look to use Skills before, or as an alternative to, dice rolling. Skills are narrative and open to player interpretation. If you think you can use a Skill in a given situation, suggest it to the Narrator.

Shaping can change things, for better or worse: Shaping is a powerful tool, one that gives players a significant degree of narrative control. Challenges and situations can be made easier or harder based on Shaping. The Narrator will respond to details you create, so try to make things easier on yourself and those around you by Shaping creatively.

Failure is part of learning: *Mappa Mundi* rewards failure. Characters get better by both succeeding and failing Ability Checks. While your Chronicler might sustain injuries during their journey, they cannot die outside of exceptional circumstances, so embrace failure as a learning experience.

Collaboration is key: *Mappa Mundi* is designed around the group. For one to succeed, all must be involved. In the same spirit, the Narrator is not an antagonist. They are there to help you create a collective story, so treat them as a collaborator, not an enemy. They will do the same.

Write your Chronicle: *Mappa Mundi* tells the story of everyday heroes: normal people putting themselves in danger and difficulty for the benefit of others. Chroniclers are driven to understand and document the world, so do that on their behalf. Take notes during sessions, draw sketches, and fill in your maps. If your group is so inclined, collect these together into a document and write the story of your journey.

Rulings not rules: *Mappa Mundi* is a narrative-focused game that doesn't seek to police creativity and invention. When situations occur that are not covered

in this Core Rules section, players and their Narrator should work together to establish a ruling to resolve the situation. This ruling might become permanent, or may only be used that one time.

Roll in the open: The Narrator will tell you the target required for a successful Ability Check. Respond to their candour by rolling where everyone can see.

Shaping

Shaping is the core mechanic *Mappa Mundi* uses for collaborative storytelling. It is the process of Chroniclers and Narrators giving form and substance to the environment around them, of adding details, minor or major, to the places, people, Monsters, and Creatures the Narrator introduces. It also allows players to introduce ideas and creations to a scene. Think of it as adding flavour text to the world, bringing it to life.

Examples of Shaping include describing the wildlife that live in the river the Chroniclers are traversing via raft; talking about the sights, sounds, and smells of a city's working-class neighbourhood; sharing the way your Chronicler feels in a given situation, often in response to the landscape they're in; describing how a Monster swims through the swamp it calls home; or describing the way a Creature rears its young.

Chroniclers may Shape at any time, either on their own initiative or when invited to by the Narrator. Shaping takes place most commonly during challenges or tasks set by the Narrator during the Journey Phase, and when a new Behaviour has been uncovered.

The world is what you make of it, and Shaping makes that process possible. If a particularly difficult challenge confronts you, inventive use of Shaping can make it easier. When climbing a difficult cliff, Shape previously unseen handholds into the rock. The Narrator can then make the task easier for others.

Shaping has only one rule: **don't erase or contradict the contributions of others, including the Narrator.** Instead, embellish on what has come before.

Abilities, Dice, and Checks

Mappa Mundi uses four Abilities: Traversal, Observation, Deduction, and Exploration. They are the basis for interacting with the world, and each player uses a single die (referred to as a Bone) to represent their **Training** in a given ability.

Traversal is the ability to **physically move through** the world. **Observation** is the ability to **use one's senses to understand** the world. **Deduction** is the ability to **formulate plans** and **investigate** the world. **Exploration** is the ability and drive to **discover** the world.

During Character Creation, you assign one die from your set to each of these Abilities. The value of the die you assign represents your level of Training in that Ability. A D4 represents a relative newcomer, while a D12 represents mastery. As you progress through the game, you will be able to upgrade your dice to reflect your increasing capabilities. We cover this in the **Character Development** section (page 64).

These dice are used to make **Ability Checks**. When required, the Narrator will request you make an Ability Check in relation to one Ability. To make the Ability Check, roll the die associated with that Ability. **Rolling equal to or above the target is a success, while rolling below the target is a failure.**

Narrators may also ask for a **Group Check**. In this case, two or more players will be asked to make Ability Checks and the Narrator will explain if the group failed or succeeded by assessing how many people managed to meet or exceed their target numbers. A tie on a Group Check is assumed to be a failure.

Chroniclers should keep track of both successes and failures when making Ability Checks and note them on their Character Sheet. Successes and failures are used when upgrading dice, and Narrators will inform you as to which result you have received.

Each Chronicler also carries a D2 or a coin with them. These are used when making Fate Checks, which are discussed in the **Fate Points and Checks** section later on this page.

Skills

Alongside Ability Checks, Skills are used by Chroniclers for more specific moments of overcoming challenges or contributing to scenarios. In *Mappa Mundi*, Skills are presented narratively; each has a name and a short description. They are also used narratively, such as when investigating, talking to NPCs, observing and engaging with Monsters, and travelling through the Wilds. Whenever a Chronicler believes that one of their Skills may help, they may state they wish to use it.

Skills may be used to replace an Ability Check. If the Narrator asks for an Ability Check, the Chronicler may suggest using one of their Skills instead. The final decision is made by the Narrator, but the Chronicler's justification for use of the Skill must be considered. The Narrator may accept the use of the Skill and have the Chronicler automatically pass that Ability Check. They may reject the use of the Skill and have the Chronicler complete the Ability Check as normal. Finally, they may allow the Skill to reduce the difficulty of the Ability Check.

Each Skill is linked to one of the four Abilities. Whenever a Chronicler uses a Skill, **they should award themselves a point of Expertise in the associated Ability**. Expertise is used to unlock new Skills along **Skill Paths**, which are discussed in the Character Development section (page 64).

Fate Points and Fate Checks

Chroniclers may be awarded Fate Points by their Narrator for in-game actions that advance the story and constitute good roleplaying. Fate Points are rare and precious, and should be given out sparingly.

A Chronicler may spend a Fate Point to make a Fate Check to attempt to alter the outcome of a situation. To make a Fate Check, the player rolls a D2 or flips a coin. Minor situations can be changed with a single Fate Point, while major situations may require several.

Players may spend Fate Points to unlock new Interactions. The first time this is done by any player, the cost is five Fate Points. For every subsequent use by any player, the cost increases by two.



The Three Phases

Mappa Mundi campaigns are split into **Chapters**.

These Chapters may last a single gameplay session or take several sessions to complete. Whatever their length, each Chapter contains Three Phases: a **Research Phase**, a **Journey Phase**, and an **Encounter Phase**. These phases give structure to Chapters, and allow the Narrator to progress the game.

The Three Phases are narratively linked.

Chroniclers typically begin their adventure by seeking information about a target (Research Phase), then travel through the Wilds to find that target (Journey Phase), and finally engage with that target in order to understand it (Encounter Phase). This structure will sometimes deviate, and Narrators can switch the order of the Phases to suit the needs of the narrative. Narrators may also include more than one of each phase in a Chapter.

There are also important mechanical links between the Three Phases. **During the Research Phase**, as Chroniclers are making discoveries, finding relevant information, and gaining understanding of their target and its surroundings, the Narrator builds a **Journey Deck**. The Journey Deck is made up of Journey Cards, each of which features a different landscape or habitat. Creature Cards and Opportunity Cards may also be present. The Narrator builds the Chapter's Journey Deck in response to the party's findings, changing the order and orientation of the cards based on successful or failed Ability Checks, as well as any discoveries the party makes or things they overlook.

During the Journey Phase, the party travels through the Wilds according to the cards in the Journey Deck. Chroniclers must overcome challenges and obstacles, resolve situations and scenarios, and avoid trouble and injury during their travels. The orientation of each card revealed from the Journey Deck determines the level of difficulty or type of challenge the Chroniclers will face.

If the card is **Rightwise**, with its nameplate at the top, the challenge or situation will be easier. If the card is **Inverted**, with its nameplate at the bottom, the challenge will be difficult or dangerous. As the party

travels the Wilds, overcoming its hazards and Shaping the landscape, they can change the orientation of the cards by succeeding at the Narrator's challenges.

During the Encounter Phase, when the party comes face-to-face with their target, the final status of the Journey Deck directly affects the **Posture** of the target, which will be either **Passive** or **Aggressive**. A target's Posture determines the difficulty level of the encounter: a Passive target will tolerate more intrusion than an Aggressive target, giving Chroniclers more opportunities to reveal its Behaviours.

If more than half of the cards revealed during the Journey Phase have a Rightwise orientation, the Encounter Phase target will have a Passive Posture. If more than half of the cards revealed during the Journey Phase have an Inverted orientation, the Encounter Phase target will have an Aggressive Posture. In the event of a tie, Narrators should ask a random player to make a Fate Check. The results of the Check will act as a tiebreaker, with an even result acting as another Rightwise card and an odd result acting as another Inverted card.

Each Phase calls for its own style of gameplay.

Research Phases are marked by investigation, information gathering, and discovery. Conversations with NPCs and use of Skills are the primary tools used during this phase.

Journey Phases are defined by exploration, overcoming obstacles, and Shaping the environment. Ability Checks feature most prominently in the Journey Phase, but Skills are also useful options. Shaping is most prominent during the Journey Phase, as the Wilds open up before you.

Encounter Phases are defined by positioning, understanding, problem solving, and close contact with Monsters. Interactions – special actions used to help reveal Behaviours – are most effective during this phase, and Chroniclers must surmount challenges set by the Narrator to fully understand a Monster.

Encounter Phases are *Mappa Mundi's* take on the 'boss fight,' and should be tense experiences despite not featuring combat. Chroniclers must unlock the Behaviours of intelligent beings by entering potentially dangerous situations, all without doing harm.

Behaviours

In *Mappa Mundi*, every Monster and Creature has a set of unique **Behaviours**. These are the traits, aspects, and actions that define them. Discovered individually, they disclose pieces of information; revealed as a whole, Behaviours are the very substance of life and existence. **Generally speaking, Monsters will have eight Behaviours, while Creatures will have four.**

Each Behaviour is linked to an **Interaction**. Chroniclers use these Interactions, and sometimes their Skills, to reveal the linked Behaviour, if relevant. Revealing Behaviours is an act of problem solving. Chroniclers must solve the puzzle based on the knowledge they have gained about the target, position themselves in advantageous places, and use Interactions they think are relevant to uncover the target's Behaviours.

Behaviours range from the mundane to the spectacular, from the **physical condition** of a target and its **living situation** to its **appearance** and beyond. Behaviours also reveal information about the target's **habitat, style of locomotion, and reproductive style.**

Some Monsters will exhibit **Tiered Behaviours**. These are Behaviours that are initially hidden and must be unlocked by observing other Behaviours. If a target has Tiered Behaviours, its Bestiary entry will state the requirements to unlock them. An example of a Tiered Behaviour could be a fish Monster who only comes out at night and glows in the water. Chroniclers must first reveal its **Nocturnal** Behaviour before they can witness its **Luminescent** Behaviour.

Interactions

Interactions are special actions used to prompt and reveal Monster and Creature Behaviours. They can also be used during engagements with NPCs, though they will not reveal Behaviours unless specified.

Interactions are most commonly used during the Encounter Phase. Each Monster and Creature Behaviour is linked to certain Interactions. Selecting the appropriate Interactions to use during the Encounter Phase will reveal the linked Behaviours, allowing Chroniclers to learn about their target.

Like Skills, Interactions are primarily narrative. We advise beginning your actions during an Encounter by invoking the Interaction you wish to use. In this way, your Narrator can determine what your Chronicler must do to successfully use that Interaction, and may set challenges in the form of Ability Checks to facilitate its use. Using an Interaction, rather than a Skill, will always lead to an easier challenge.

When you begin an Encounter, pay attention to the description of both the scene and the target; listening carefully to this information will provide hints and clues as to which Interactions will prompt the reveal of a Behaviour.

When a Chronicler uses an Interaction that is not linked to a target's Behaviours or fails an Ability Check set by the Narrator, the target's **Threads** will be affected, as outlined in the next section.

Threads

In *Mappa Mundi*, **Threads** represent a **target's agency and self-determination**. They exist in three states: **Intact, Severed, and Frayed**. During the Encounter Phase, Chroniclers must carefully manage the target's Threads.

All Monsters and Creatures have a combination of Intact, Severed, and Frayed Threads. These are linked to their **Posture (Passive or Aggressive)** and are listed in their Bestiary entry. **Monsters and Creatures usually have the same number of Threads as they do Behaviours.** When the Encounter Phase begins, the Narrator reveals the target's Posture and its Threads.

Intact Threads can become Frayed – usually when a minor challenge has been failed – or Severed – when a Chronicler uses an unlinked Interaction or angers or scares the target. Frayed Threads can be repaired using certain Interactions and Skills. Chroniclers should state that they wish to repair a Thread when declaring their action. Severed Threads cannot be repaired.

If all Threads are Severed, the Encounter Phase immediately ends. In this situation, something bad will likely occur, including the target possibly fleeing, attacking the Chroniclers, or damaging the environment around it.



Character Development

In *Mappa Mundi*, players can develop their Chronicler in four ways: **Training, Expertise, Specialisations and Endorsements**, and by gaining **new Interactions**. Training refers to the values of their dice, which can be upgraded. Expertise allows players to unlock new Skills for their Chroniclers, including Specialisations and Endorsements. New Interactions are either gained by spending Fate Points or awarded to players by the Narrator.

Training

Training is the measure of a Chronicler's proficiency in the four Abilities (Traversal, Observation, Deduction, and Exploration). A Chronicler's current level of training is represented by the die (Bone) associated with that Ability. Dice increase from D4 to a D6, then to D8, and finally to D12.

Whenever a player makes an Ability Check, they should note the outcome (success or failure) on their Character Sheet next to the Ability being used. When enough successes and failures have been accumulated, the player may upgrade that Ability's die as long as they've done the following:

- Succeed on a number of relevant Ability Checks **equal to the number of faces on the new die** (six times for D6, eight times for D8, etc.)
- Fail a number of relevant Ability Checks **equal to half the number of faces on the new die** (three times for D6, four times for D8, etc.)

When upgrading dice, the Chronicler's Strength and Weakness must also be considered.

- The die associated with **Strength** must always be upgraded first. This die must always be the highest value die in the Chronicler's collection, or equal to the value of another die.
- The die associated with **Weakness** must always be upgraded last. This die cannot exceed the value of any other die in the Chronicler's collection.

The Narrator holds the right to grant dice upgrades to players at specific milestones in the game, or as a reward for excellent roleplaying. For instance, if a Chronicler has made consistent and sustained roleplaying contributions in relation to their party's Traversal, the Narrator may choose to award them a new Traversal die upgrade as a reward.

Expertise

Expertise is the measure of a Chronicler's growing proficiency in their Licence. Expertise Points are gained each time a Chronicler uses a Skill. These points are gained for the Ability linked to the Skill. Traversal Skills grant Expertise Points for Traversal, Observation Skills for Observation, and so on. These should be marked on your Character Sheet.

Skills can be found on each Licence's **Skill Path**. These Skill Paths show the routes that must be followed to unlock new Skills. Descriptions of Skills are also available (beginning on page 24 for the Archivist), detailing the Skills' name, its description, and its linked Ability.

To unlock a new Skill on their **Starting Licence Skill Path**, the player must spend the relevant Expertise Points from the Ability linked to that Skill (Deduction Expertise Points to unlock a new Deduction Skill, for example). **The number of Expertise Points needed to unlock a Skill is equal to the value of the die associated with that Ability.**

To unlock a new Skill from a different Skill Path or Licence, the player follows the same process as above. **The number of Expertise Points they must spend is equal to the value of the die associated with that Ability plus half, rounded up.** This allows players to go back and learn Skills they might have initially passed over. It also lets them develop their Chroniclers across different Licences, broadening the role they can play in the party.

When unlocking the **first Skill linked to their Weakness**, the player may spend any type of one other Expertise.

By linking the cost to unlock new Skills to the value of the player's dice, the process follows a curve that begins shallow and steadily becomes steeper. This

is to reflect the impact of Skills further along each Skill Path.

Specialisations and Endorsements

Specialisations are milestones in a Chronicler's development, representing them reaching a particular level of mastery in their field. Each Licence has three Specialisations, each placed at the midpoint of that Licence's Skill Path.

To unlock a Specialisation, a Chronicler must have unlocked **half of the Skills that directly feed into it**, rounded up in cases where there is an odd number. There is no Expertise cost to unlock a Specialisation.

Endorsements are awarded to Chroniclers who have gained specific Specialisations in two different Licences, and represent a commitment to broad understanding and practice. The Specialisations needed to unlock an Endorsement are listed in each Licence section of this rulebook. After unlocking the required Specialisations, **the player must spend a number of Expertise Points equal to the sum of the value of the dice associated with their Strength and Weakness**. Any Expertise Points can be spent to do this.

We have provided twelve Endorsements in this book. There remains room for Chroniclers to invent their own Endorsements by combining other Specialisations. If a Chronicler wishes to develop their own Endorsement, they must make the case to their group's Narrator as to why such a combination of Specialisations would lead to their developed Endorsement, as well as listing the benefits that Endorsement will confer. The final decision rests with the Narrator, but Narrators should work with the Chronicler to make the choice reasonable and acceptable wherever possible.

Injury, Sickness, and Health

Mappa Mundi is a game without combat and character death. But just because Chroniclers won't die from getting in a fight or venturing too close to a Monster or Creature doesn't mean they cannot contract sickness, become injured, or fall unconscious. Injuries and sickness have both mechanical and narrative effects.

Mappa Mundi also welcomes players with physical disabilities, mental health conditions, and neurodiversities. The term 'Injury' is wildly inaccurate for describing such conditions, but the mechanics of this system may help players who wish to reflect themselves in their Chroniclers.

Chroniclers can experience four types of Injury: **Minor, Major, Unconscious, and Transformative**.

Minor Injuries include abrasions, bruises, cuts, scratches and sprains, as well as fleeting illnesses, such as colds or nausea. These injuries are inconvenient and painful, but not debilitating. They wear off over time and can be treated with basic first aid or relevant Skills and Interactions. **While carrying a Minor Injury, the target number of all Traversal Checks is increased by one.**

Major Injuries include breaks, burns, and gashes, as well as more serious illnesses, such as dysentery or extended viral infections. These injuries are both painful and often debilitating. They will improve over time, but may have an effect even after healing. **While carrying a Major Injury, the target number of all Traversal Checks is increased by two.** Major Injuries can be treated and reduced to a Minor Injury using relevant advanced medical Skills.

Unconsciousness occurs when a Chronicler faints and can no longer participate in the action. Narrators can apply and remove the Unconscious status in response to player actions at any time during gameplay. **When a Chronicler is knocked Unconscious, they cannot take part in any actions, contribute to Group Checks, or make use of any Skills until they have regained consciousness.**

Transformative Injuries include permanent loss of sight or hearing, limb loss or paralysis, long-term sicknesses, or the effects of psychological or emotional trauma. These types of injuries are rare and should never be imposed on a player by the Narrator. **Instead, players may determine whether a Major Injury or event leads to a Transformative Injury.** The effects should be agreed upon by consensus and the player be allowed to determine the narrative consequences. Chroniclers with these types of injuries may have to use their Skills and Interactions in new ways or learn to navigate the Wilds differently.